

Nonclassicality, quasiprobabilities and weak values explored in neutron interferometry

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Weak values, weak measurements and weak interactions are **not related** to the weak force!

- Introduction
- Nonclassicality

5 min break for questions

- Quasiprobabilities and weak values
- Experimental results

Introduction

Quantum mechanics exhibits features with no classical counterpart.

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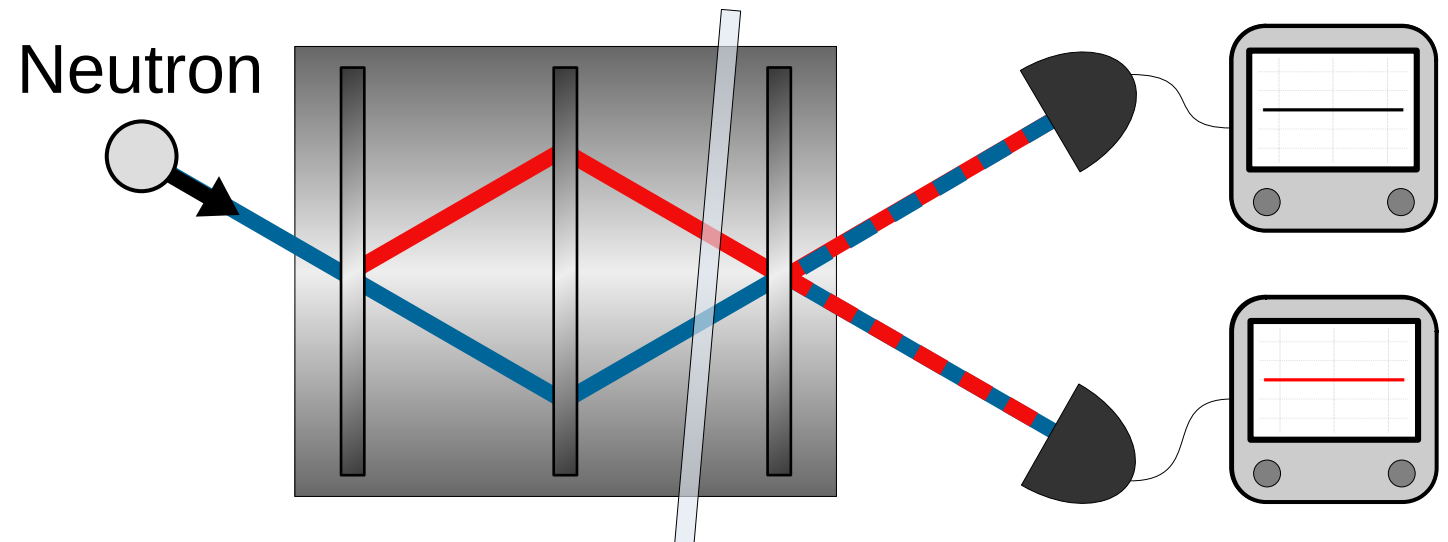
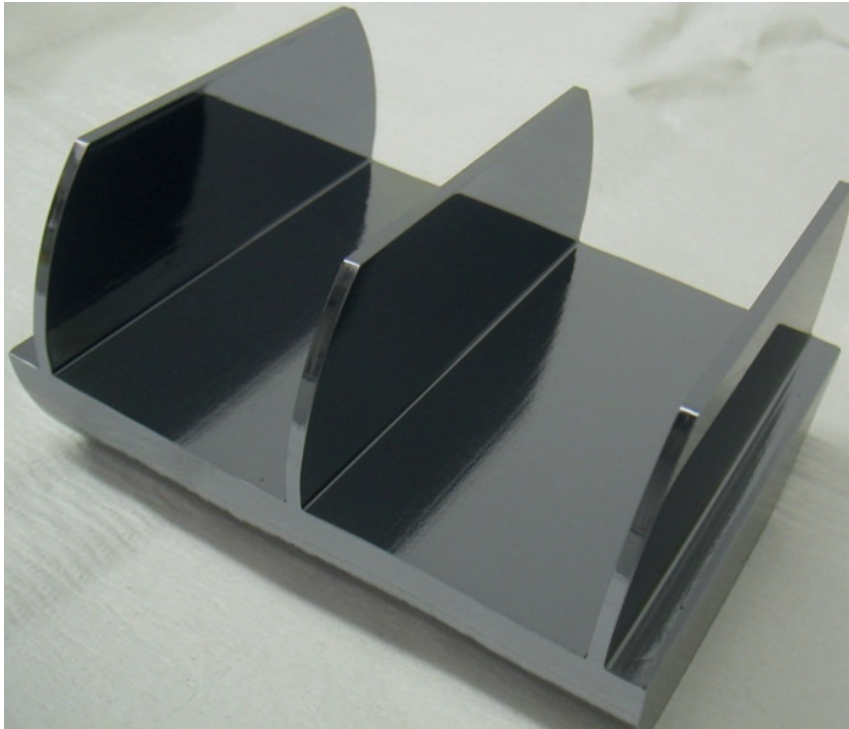
However, not all quantum mechanics is non-classical and identifying the classical/quantum boundary is of importance.

Quantum mechanics exhibits features with no classical counterpart.

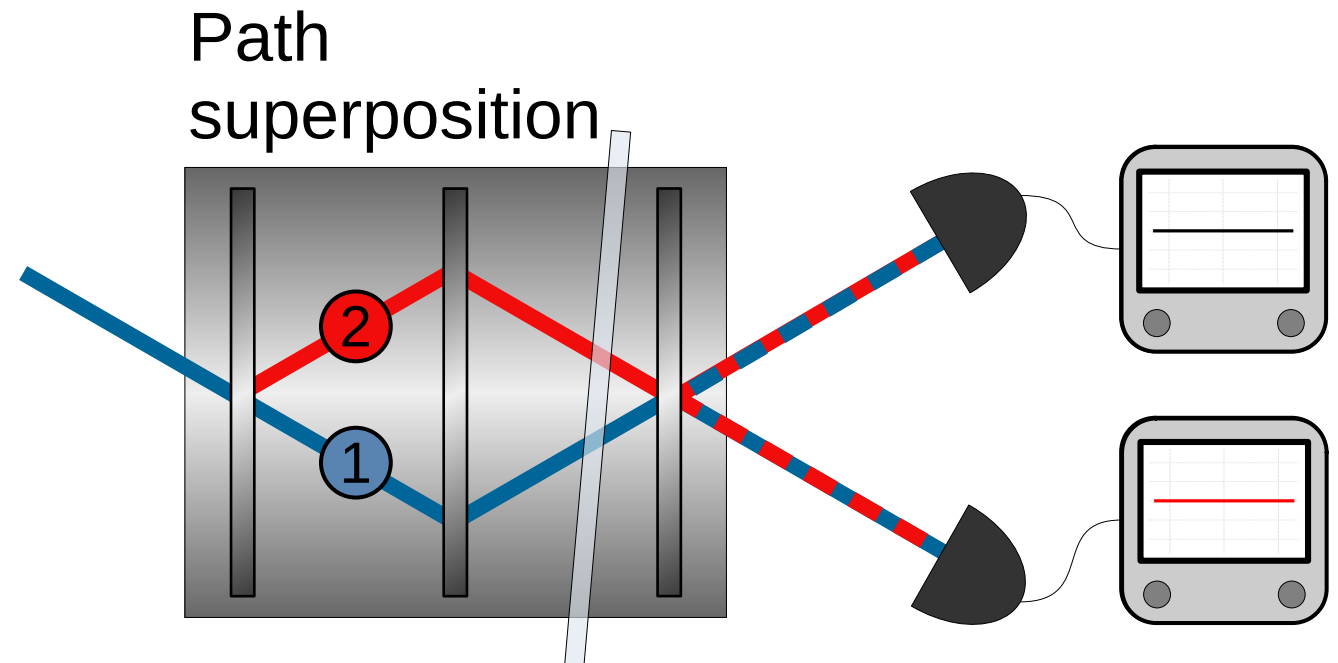
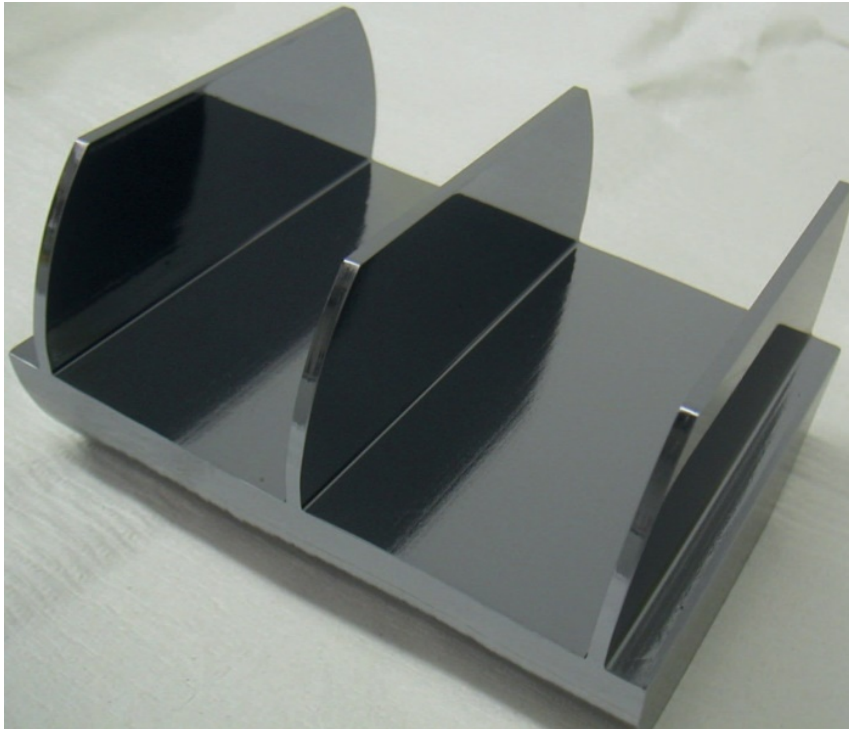
However, not all quantum mechanics is non-classical and identifying the classical/quantum boundary is of importance.

We are interested in experimental tools to probe such boundaries.

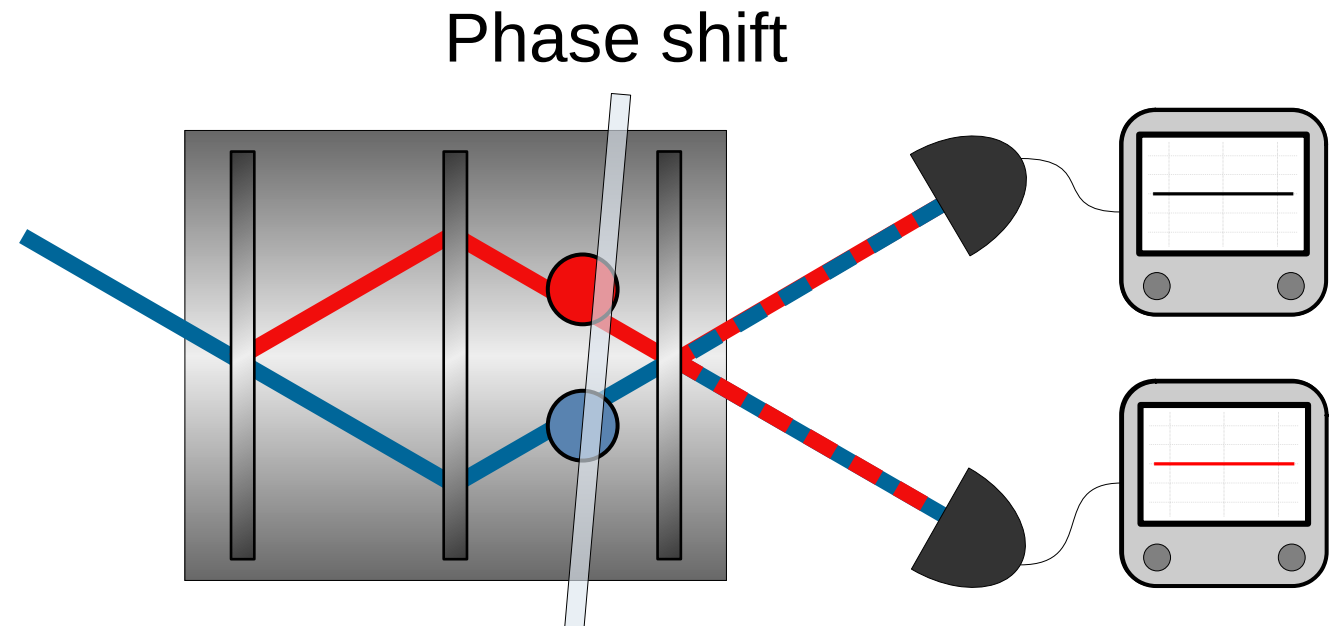
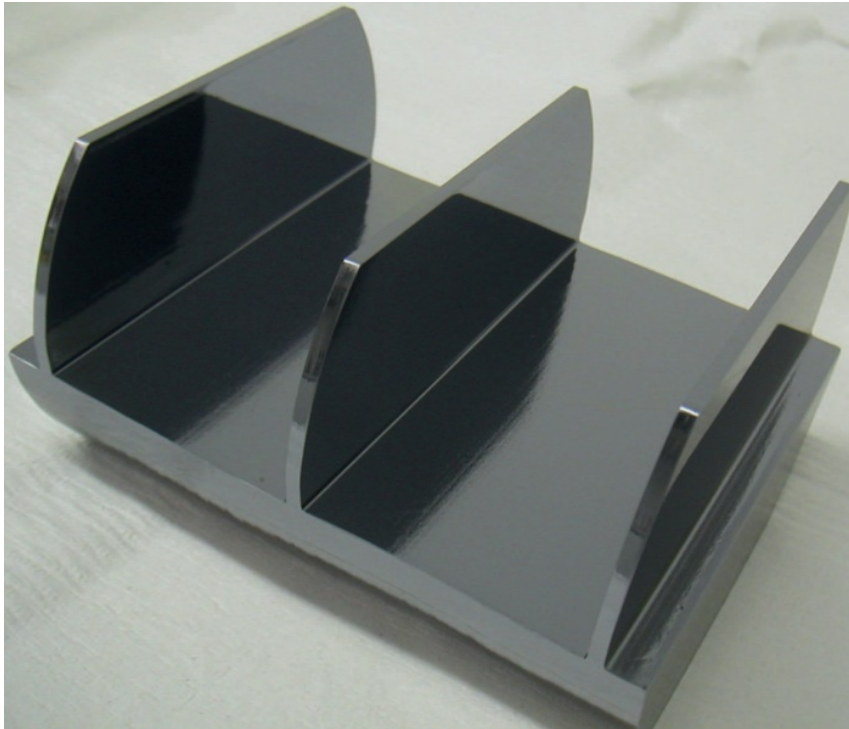
Neutron Mach-Zehnder interferometer:



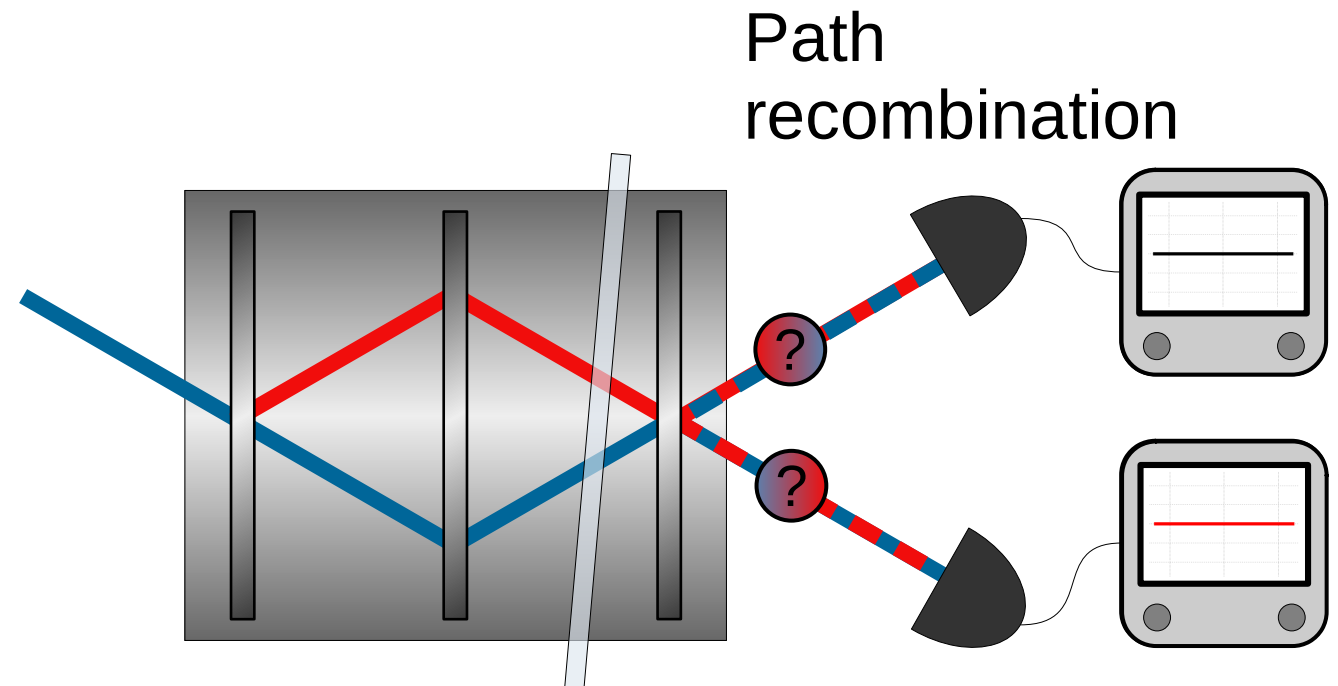
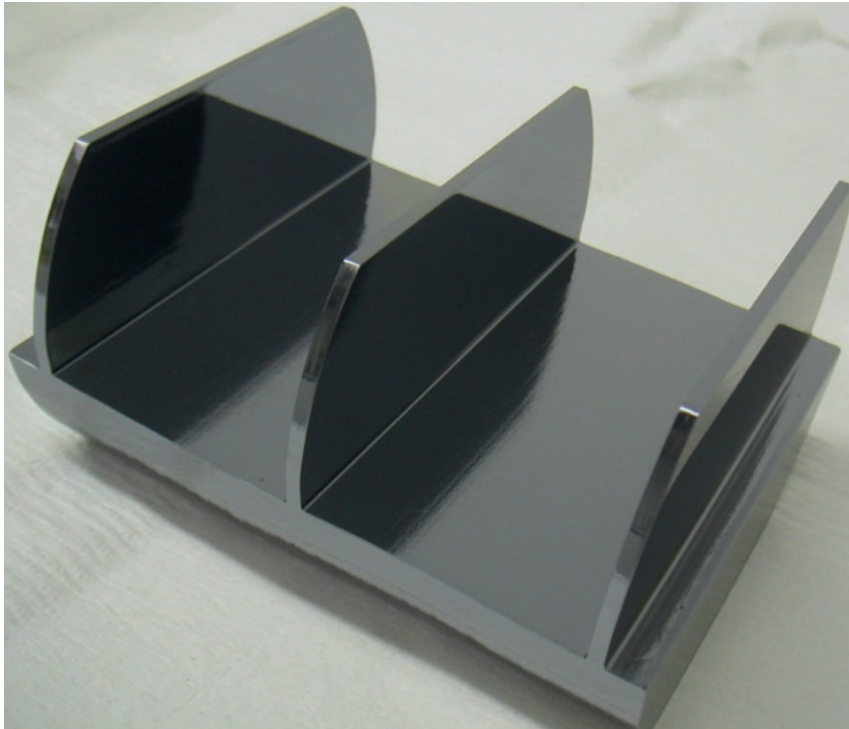
Neutron Mach-Zehnder interferometer:



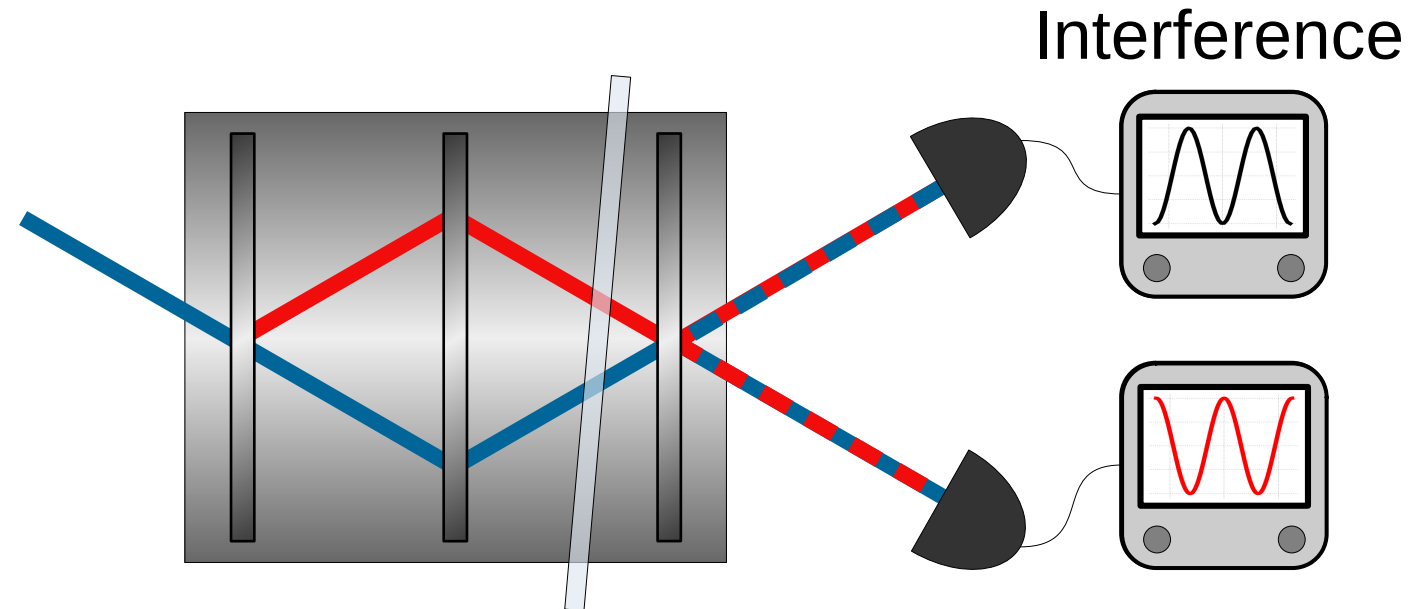
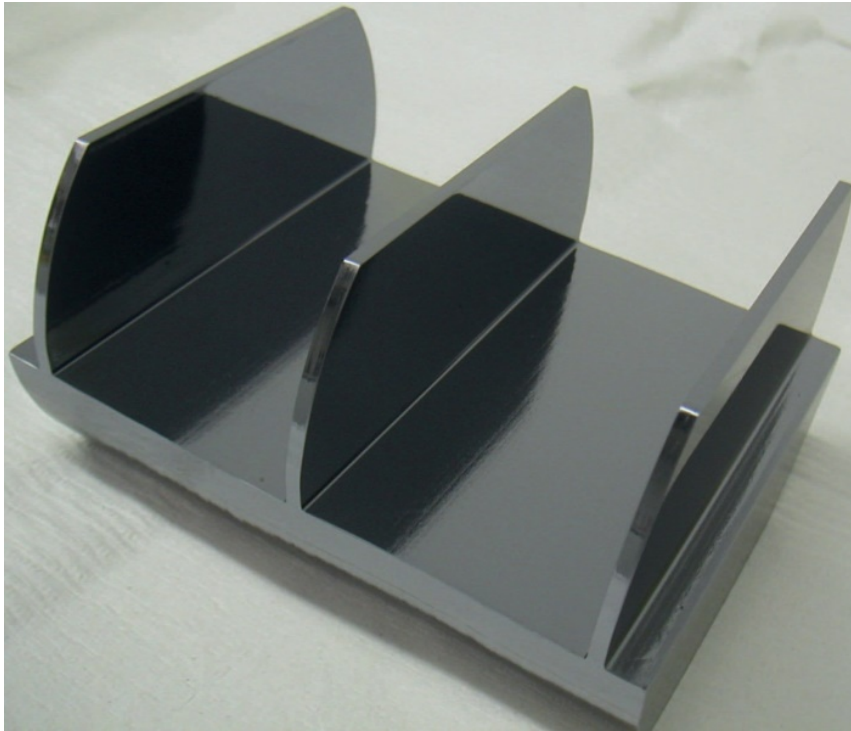
Neutron Mach-Zehnder interferometer:



Neutron Mach-Zehnder interferometer:



Neutron Mach-Zehnder interferometer:



Why neutron interferometry?

- Interference is intrinsically a single-massive-particle phenomenon.
- Matter-wave interferometry at room temperature and ambient pressure, with macroscopic beam separation and high contrast.
- Manipulation of several degrees of freedom (path, spin, energy).

Nonclassicality

Preparation (P)



Preparation (P)



System



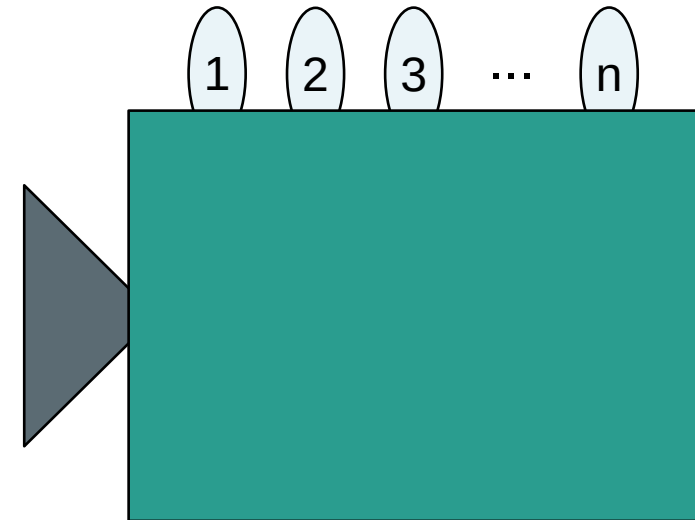
Preparation (P)



System



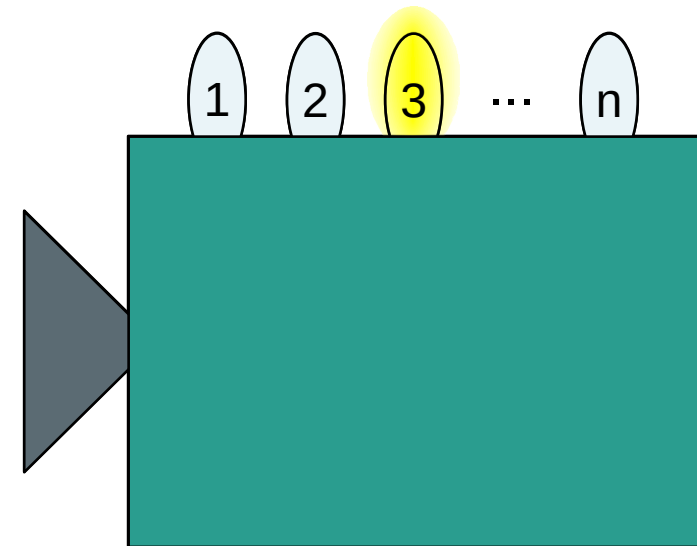
Measurement (M)



Preparation (P)



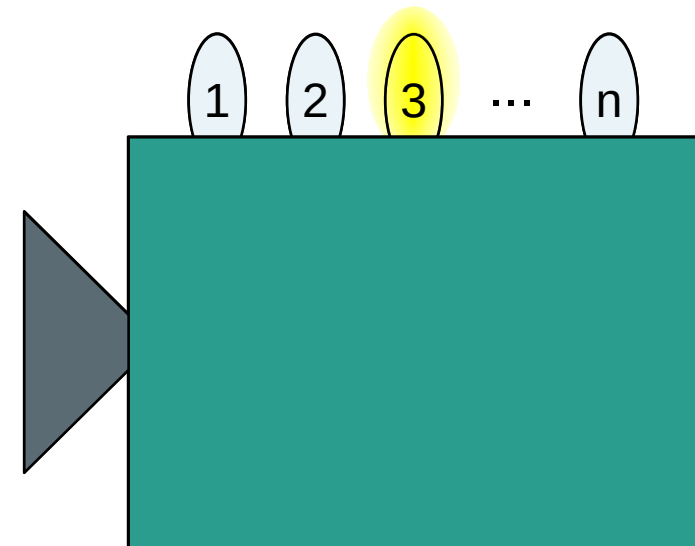
Measurement (M)



Preparation (P)

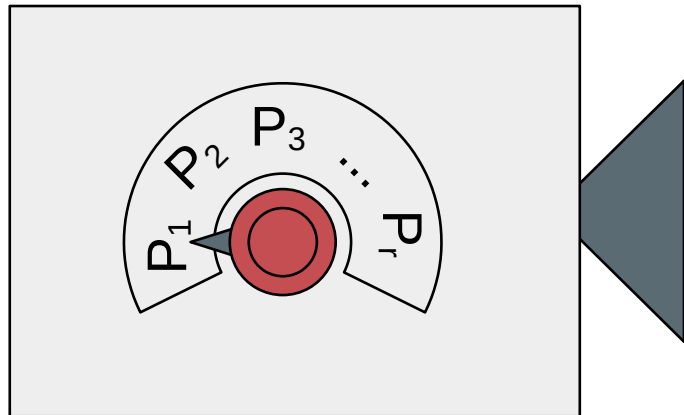


Measurement (M)

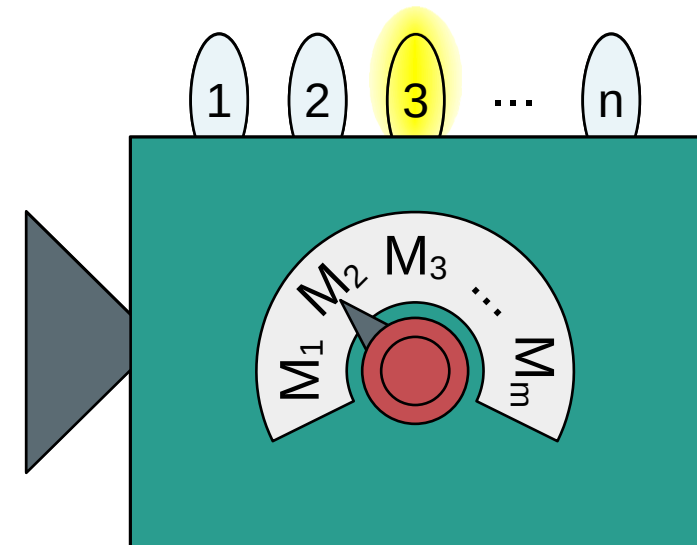


Outcome probabilities: $\text{Prob}(k|P, M)$

Preparation (P_i)



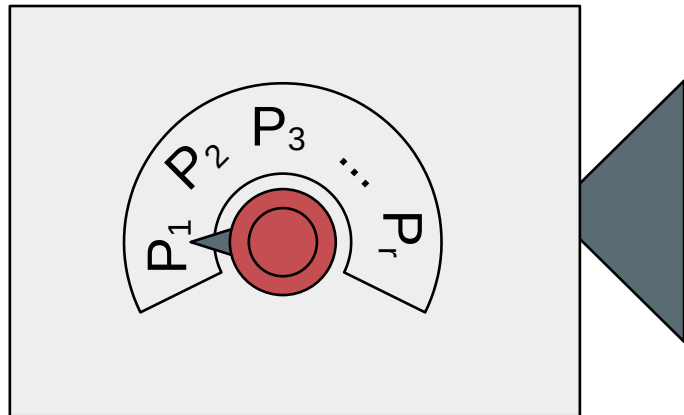
Measurement (M_j)



Outcome probabilities: $\text{Prob}(k|P_i, M_j)$

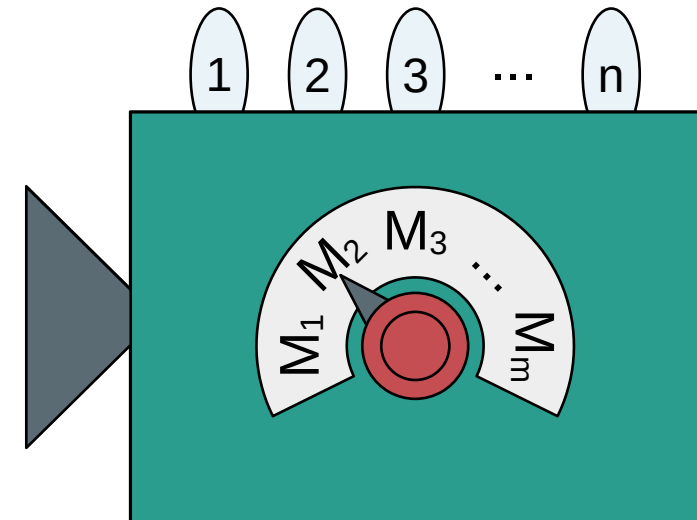
A classical experiment

Preparation (P_i)



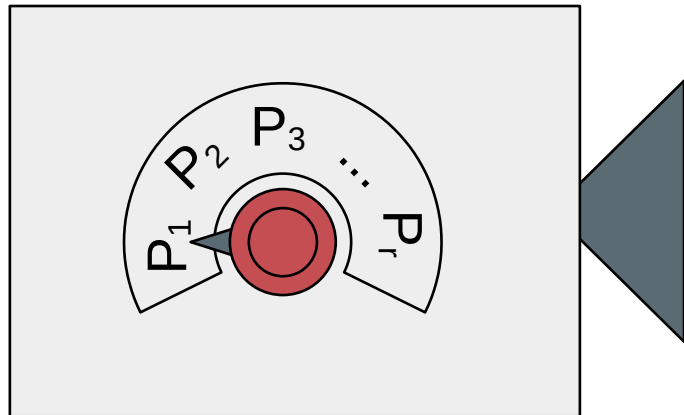
System
 λ

Measurement (M_j)

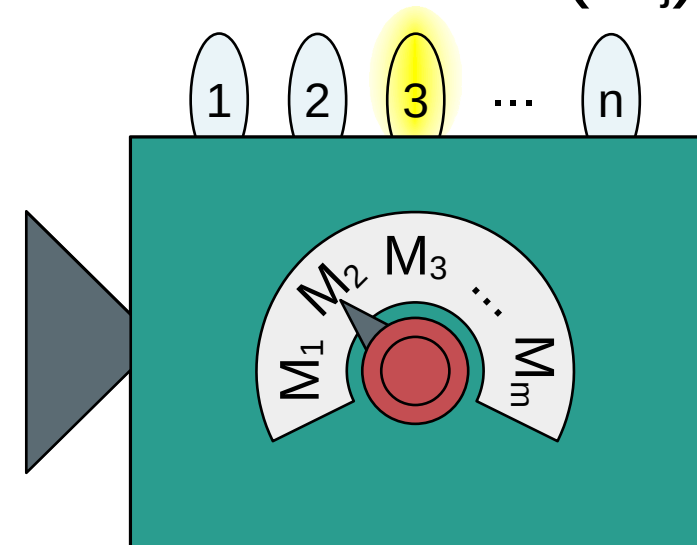


Defined set of properties: $\lambda = (\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \lambda_3, \dots, \lambda_m)$

Preparation (P_i)

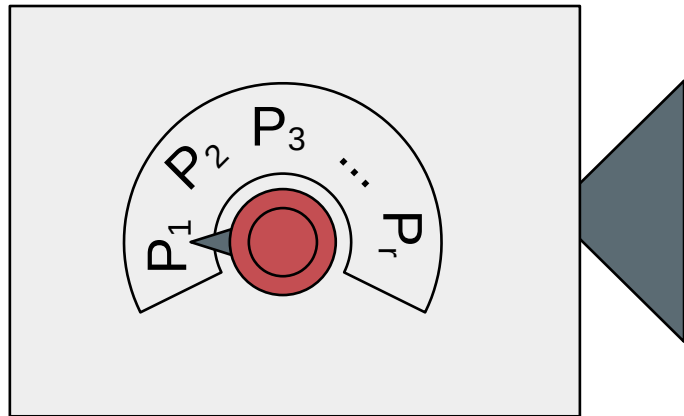


Measurement (M_j)

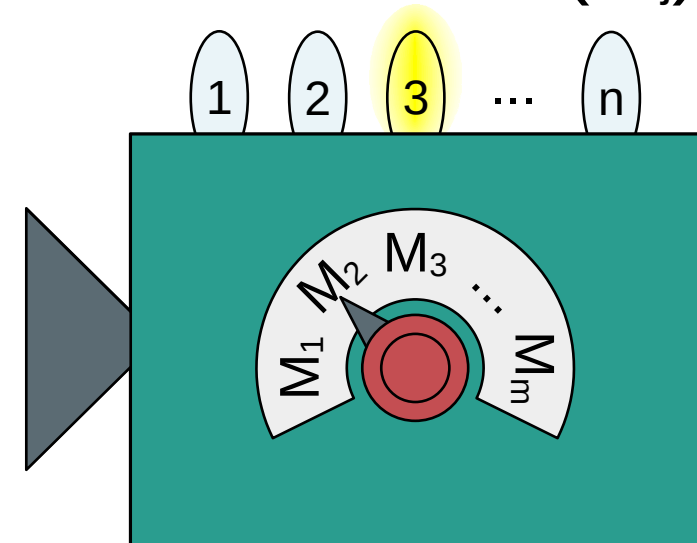


Defined set of properties: $\lambda = (\lambda_1, \lambda_2, \lambda_3, \dots, \lambda_m)$

Preparation (P_i)

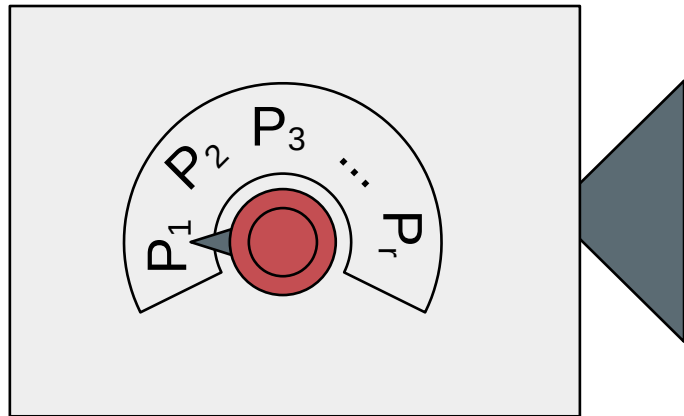


Measurement (M_j)

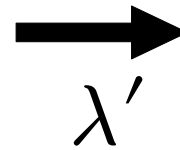


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Preparation (P_i)

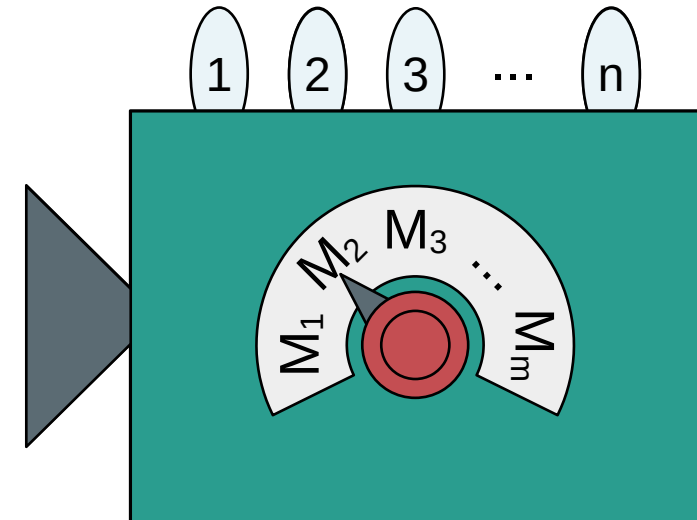


System

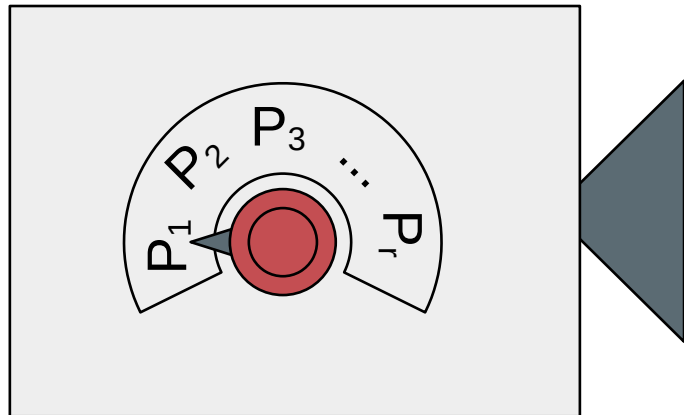


λ'
100%

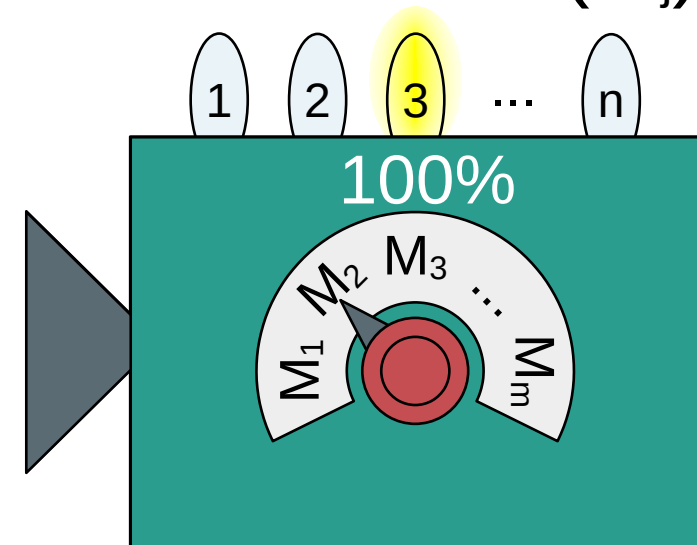
Measurement (M_j)



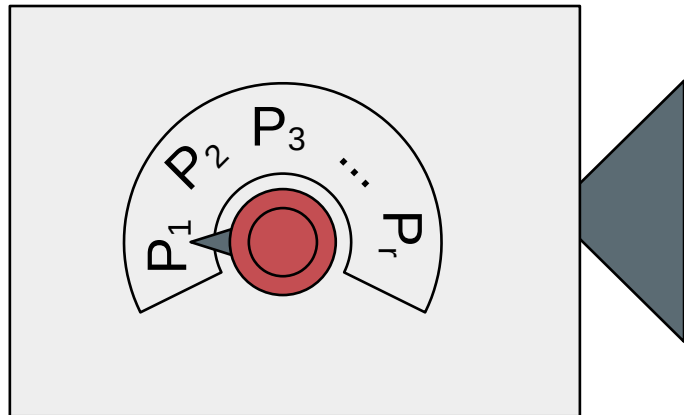
Preparation (P_i)



Measurement (M_j)

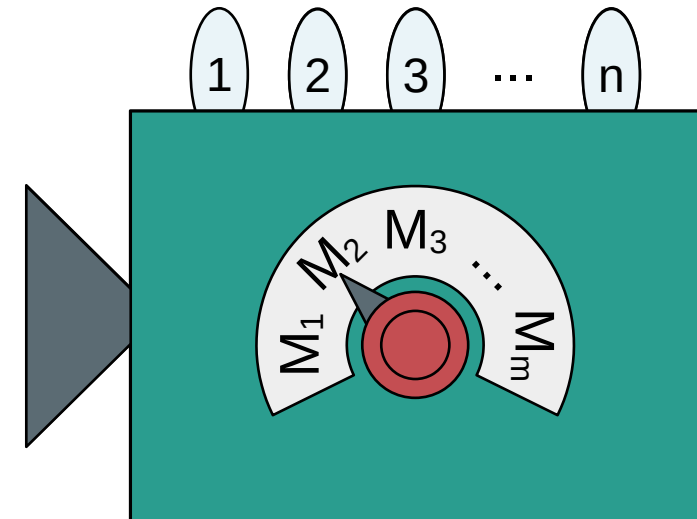


Preparation (P_i)



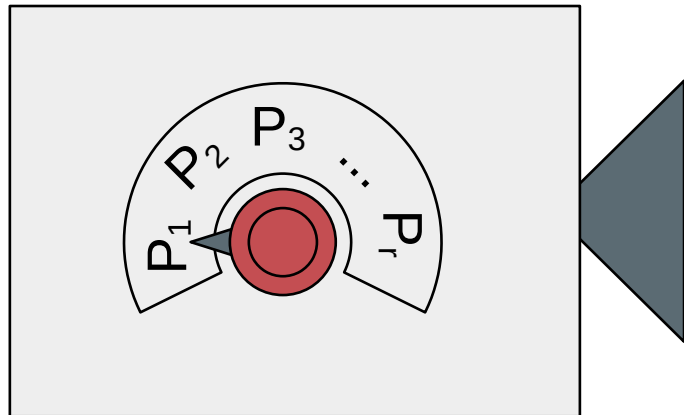
System
 λ' λ''
75% 25%

Measurement (M_j)



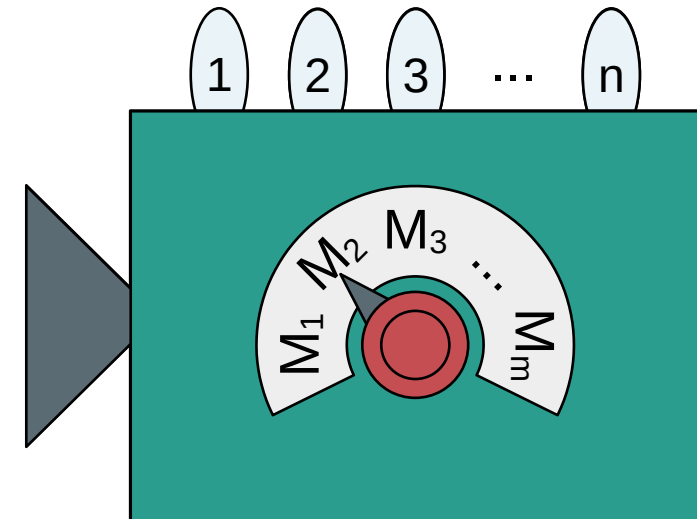
Probability distribution: $\mu(\lambda|P_i)$

Preparation (P_i)



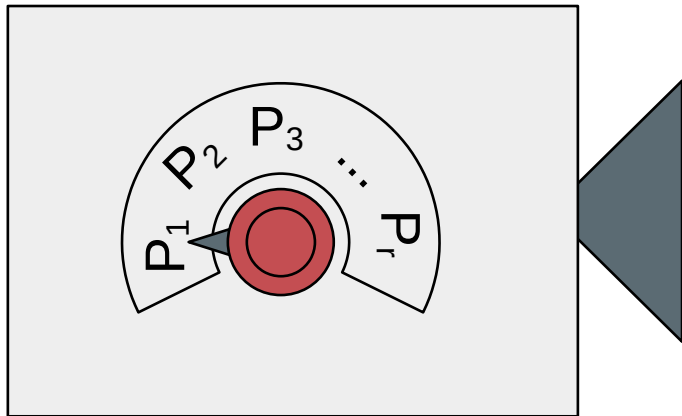
System
 λ' λ''
75% 25%

Measurement (M_j)

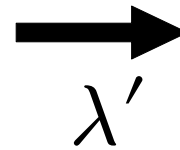


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Preparation (P_i)

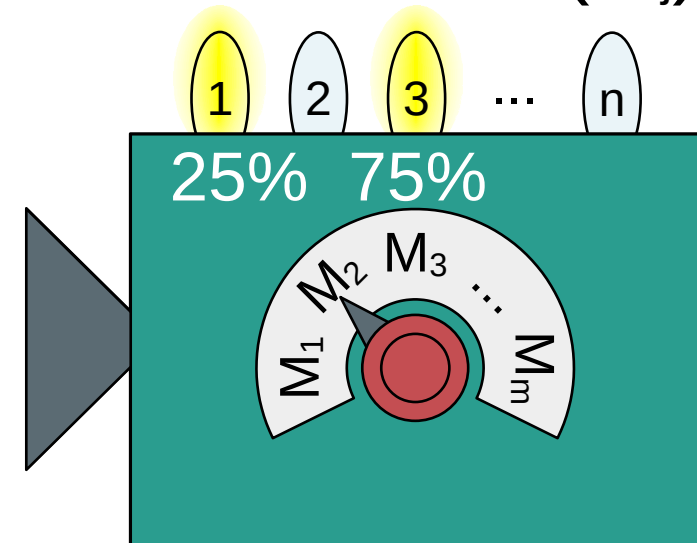


System



λ'
100%

Measurement (M_j)

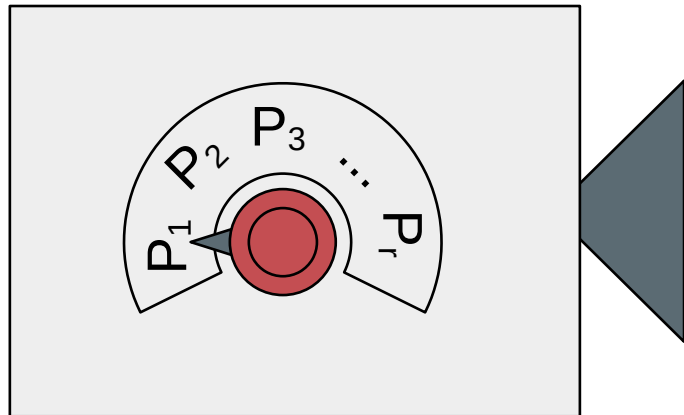


A classical experiment

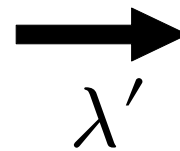
Probability distribution: $\mu(\lambda|P_i)$

Response function: $\xi(k|M_j, \lambda)$

Preparation (P_i)

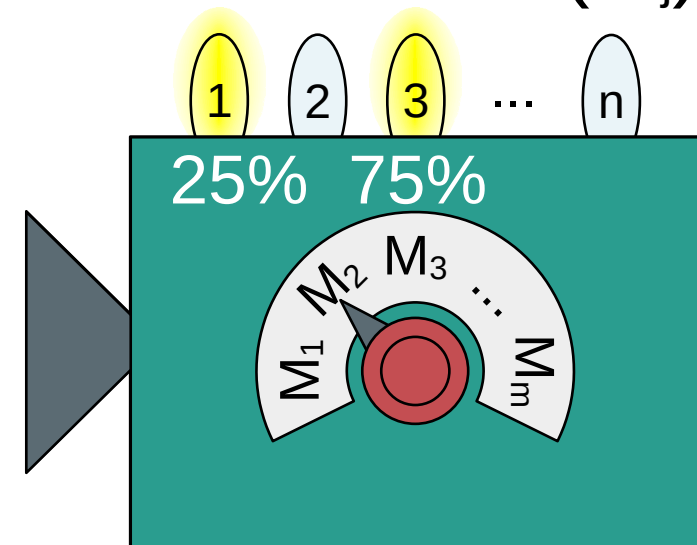


System



λ'
100%

Measurement (M_j)



Probability distribution: $\mu(\lambda|P_i)$ Response function: $\xi(k|M_j, \lambda)$

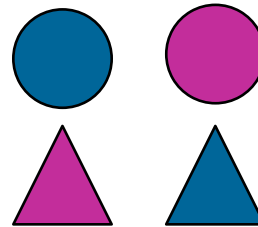
Outcome probabilities:

$$\text{Prob}(k|P_i, M_j) = \sum_{\lambda} \mu(\lambda|P_i) \xi(k|M_j, \lambda)$$

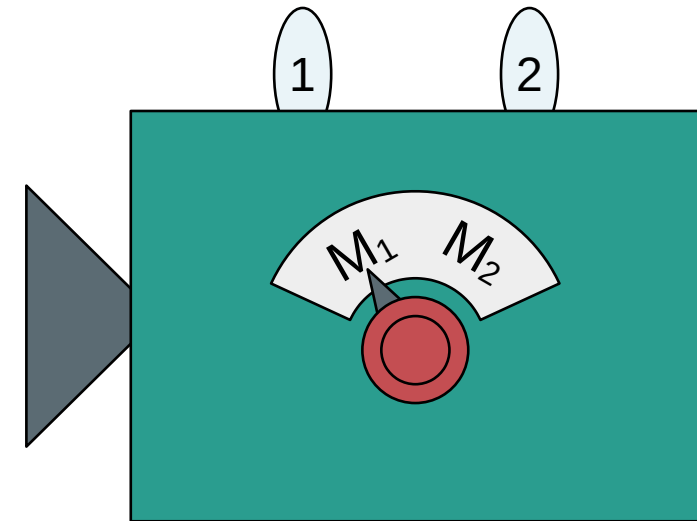
Preparation (P)



System



Measurement (M_j)

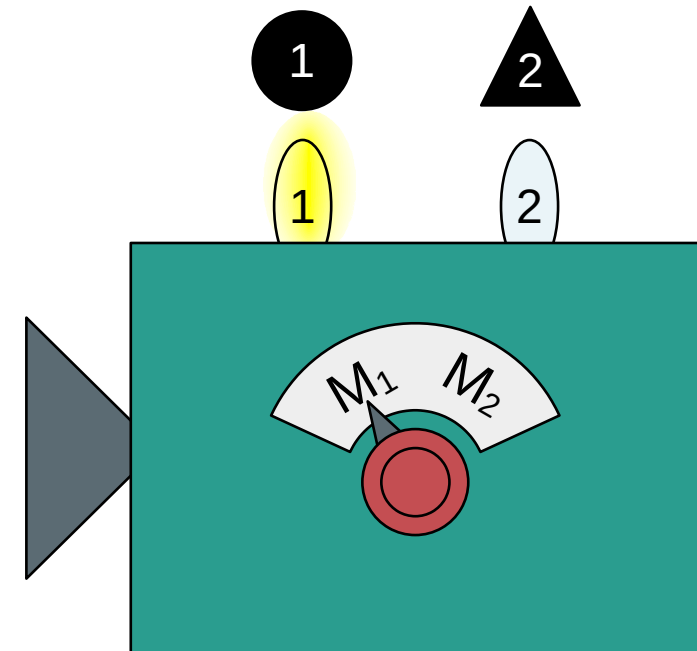


Two properties (shape, color): $\lambda = (\lambda_1, \lambda_2)$

Preparation (P)



Shape (M_1)

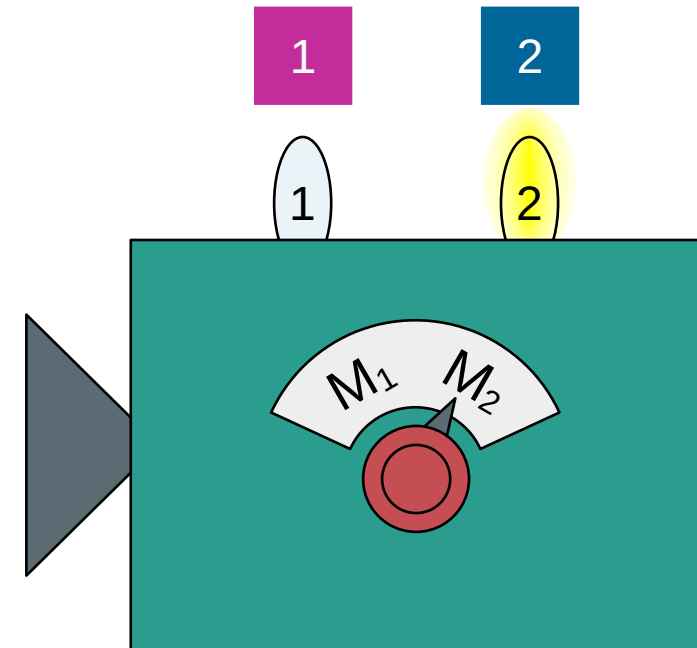


Two properties (shape, color): $\lambda = (\lambda_1, \lambda_2)$

Preparation (P)



Color (M_2)



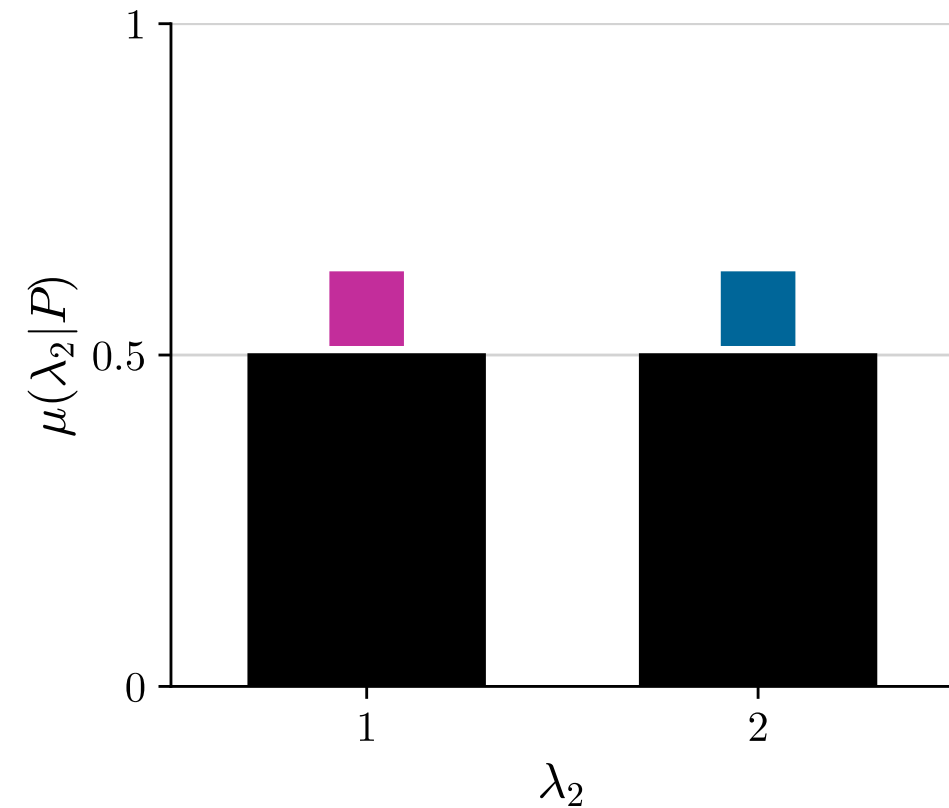
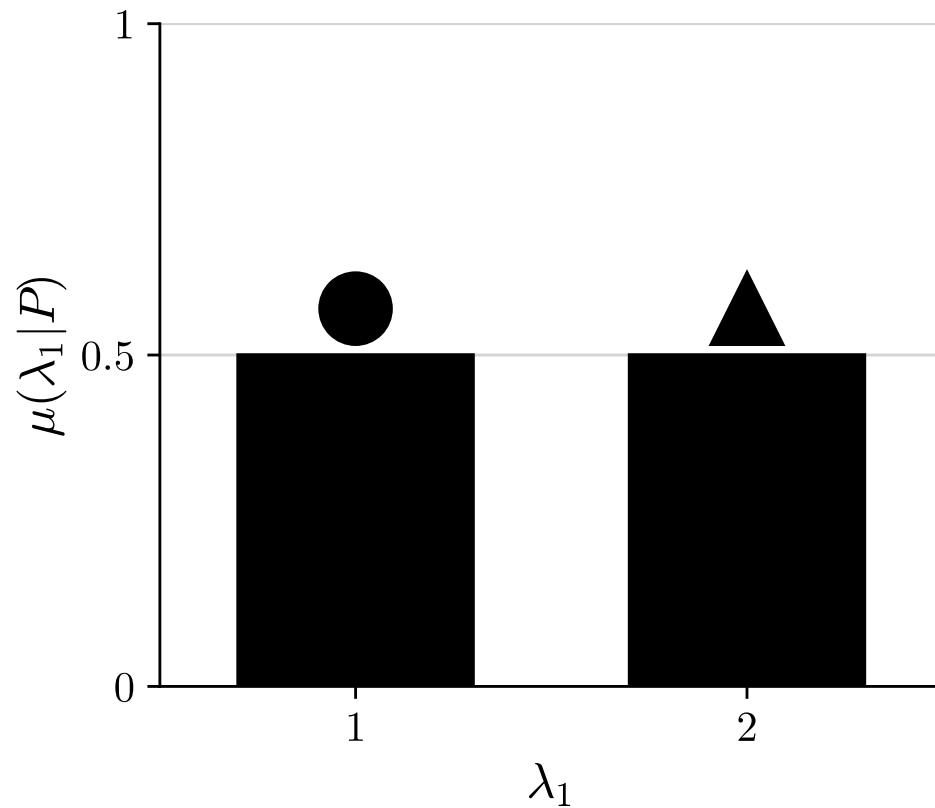
Two properties (shape, color): $\lambda = (\lambda_1, \lambda_2)$

A classical experiment

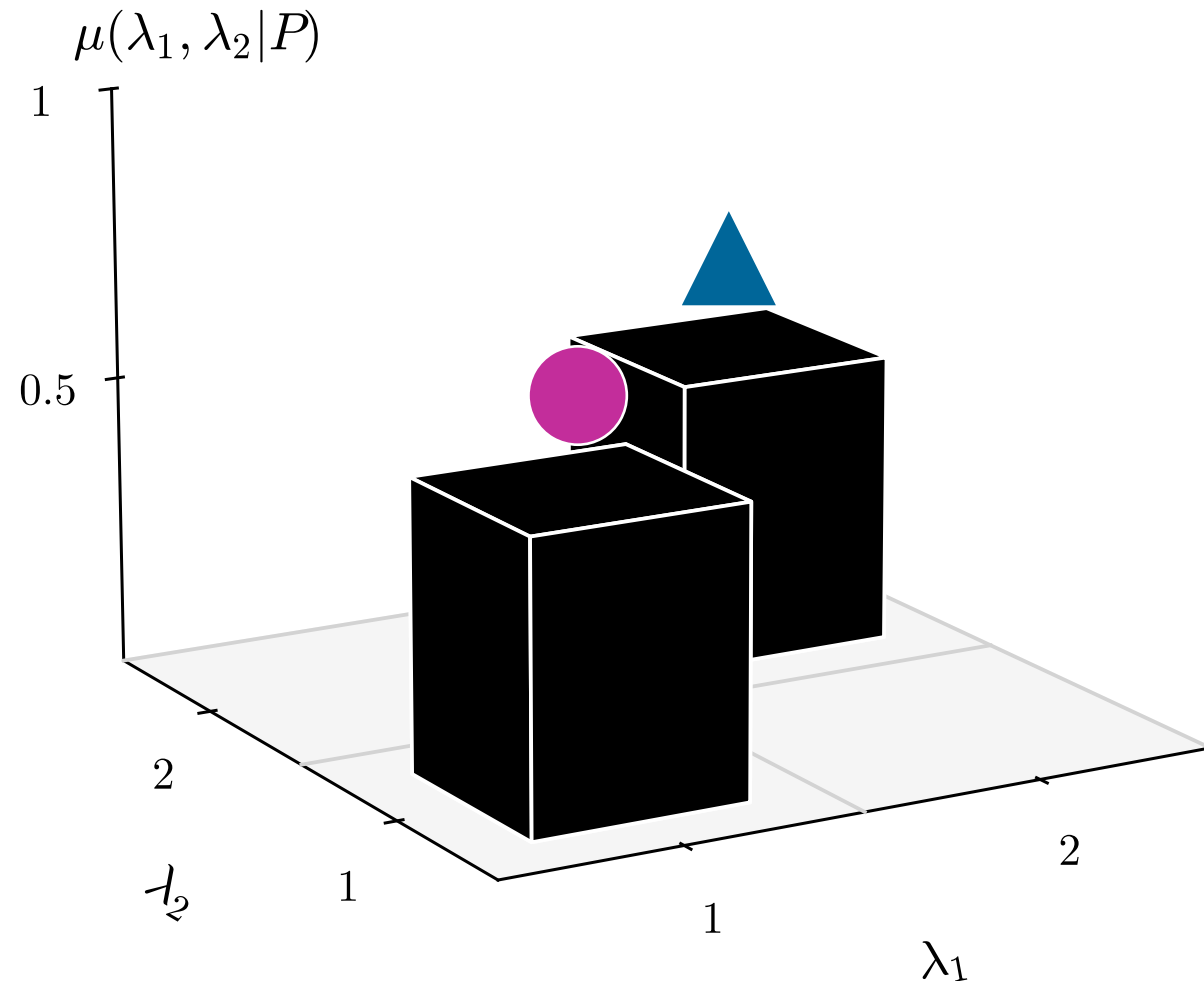
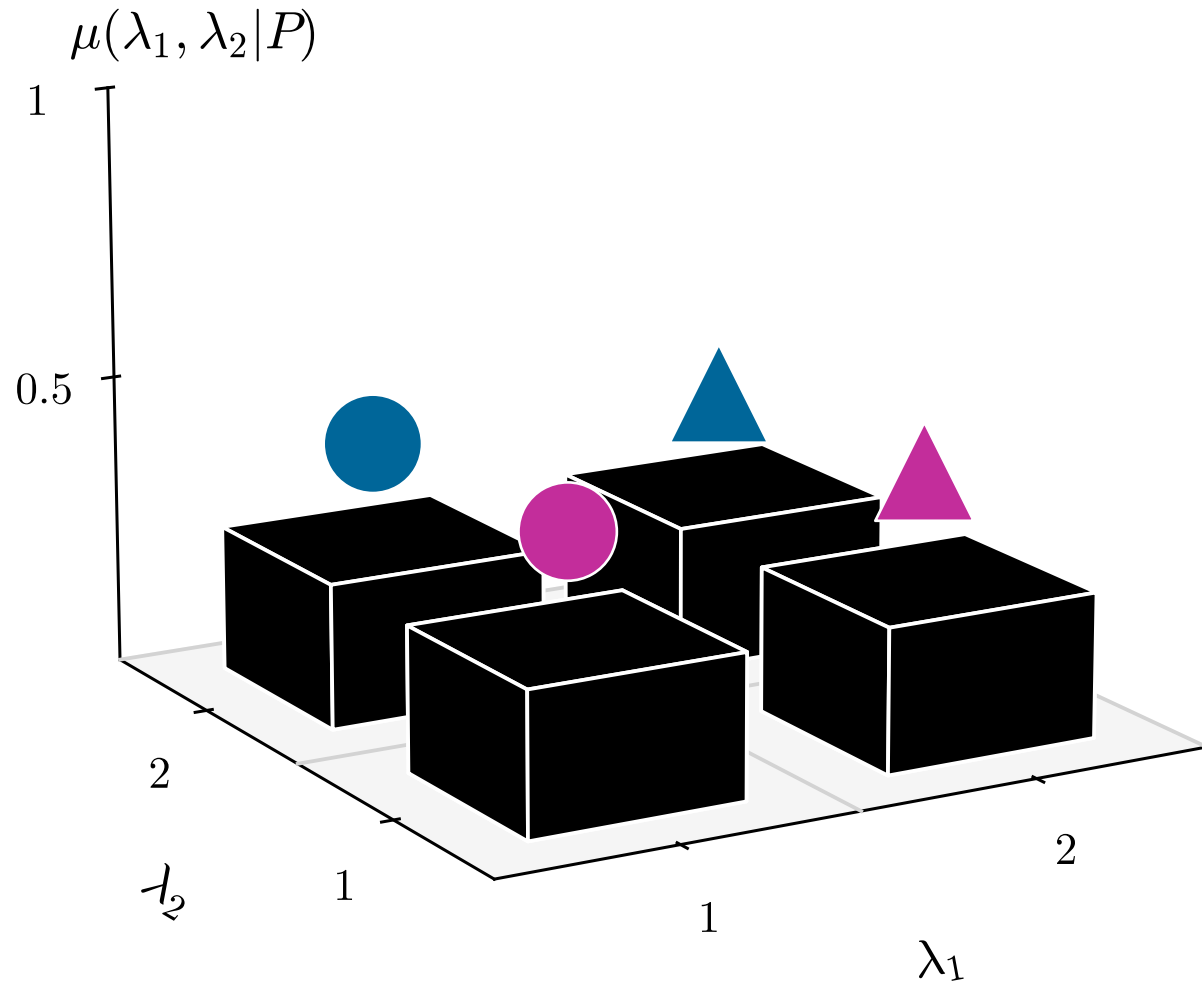
▲ 50% ● 50%

Outcome probabilities:

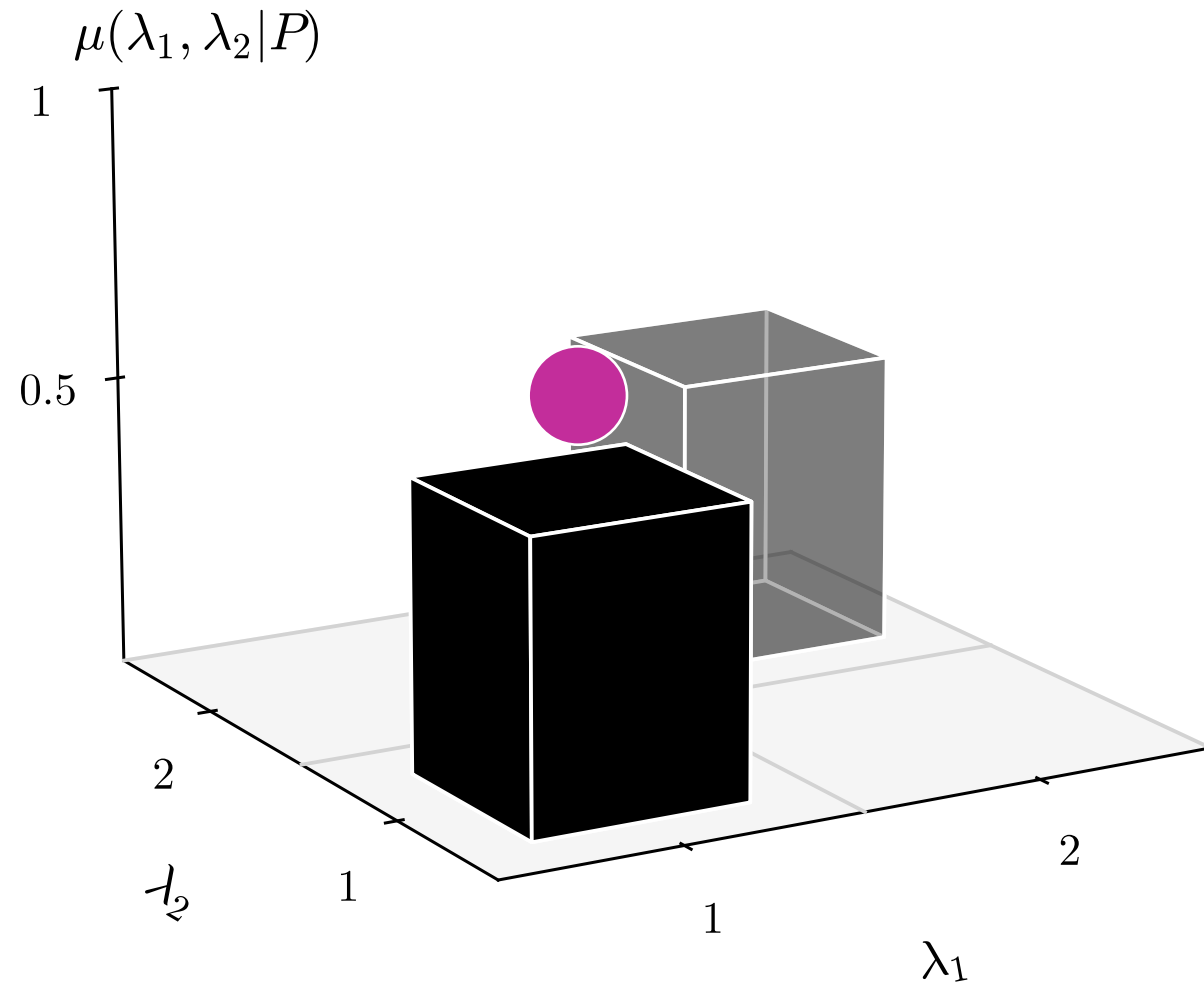
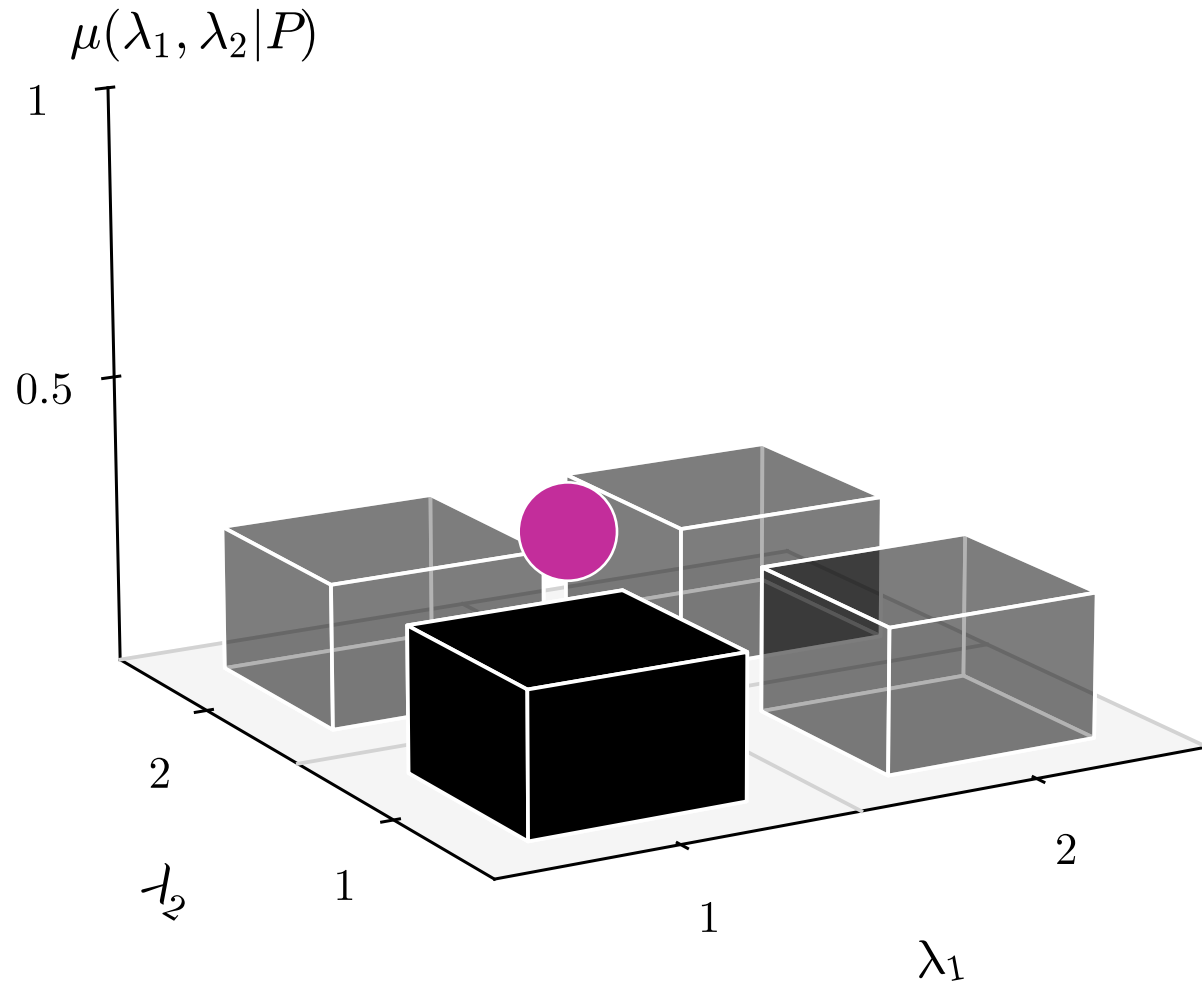
■ 50% ■ 50%



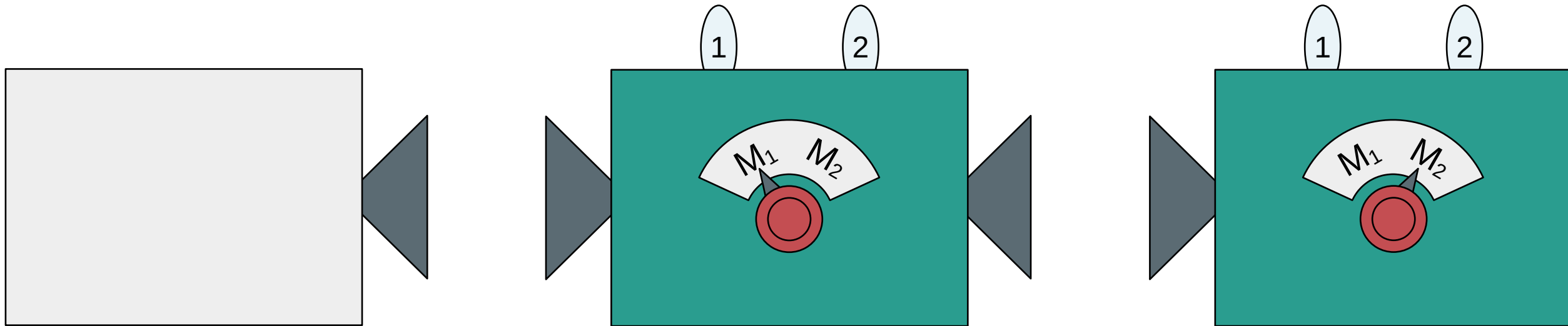
Probability distribution: $\mu(\lambda|P)$



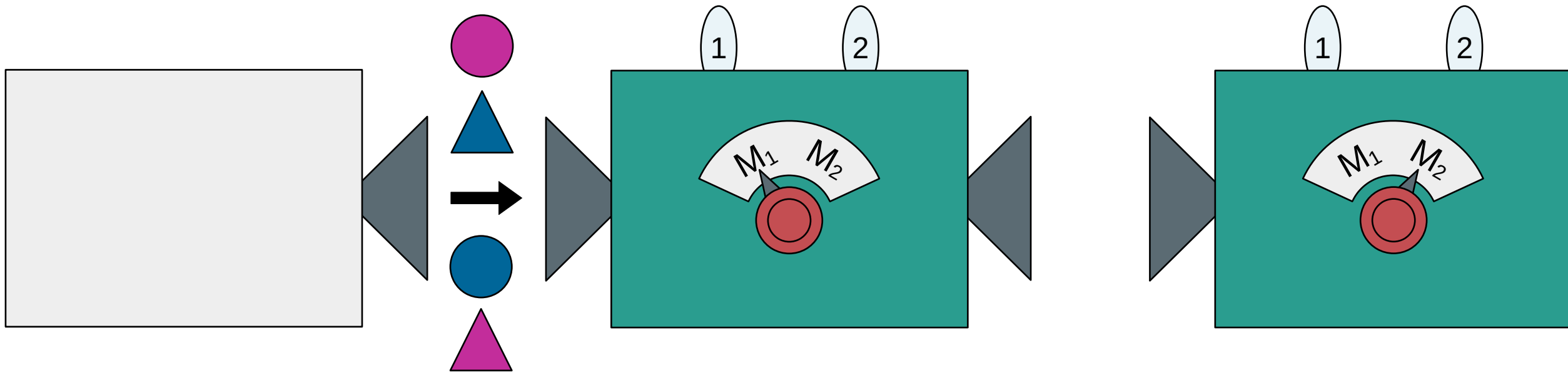
Probability distribution: $\mu(\lambda|P)$



Sequential (or simultaneous) measurement

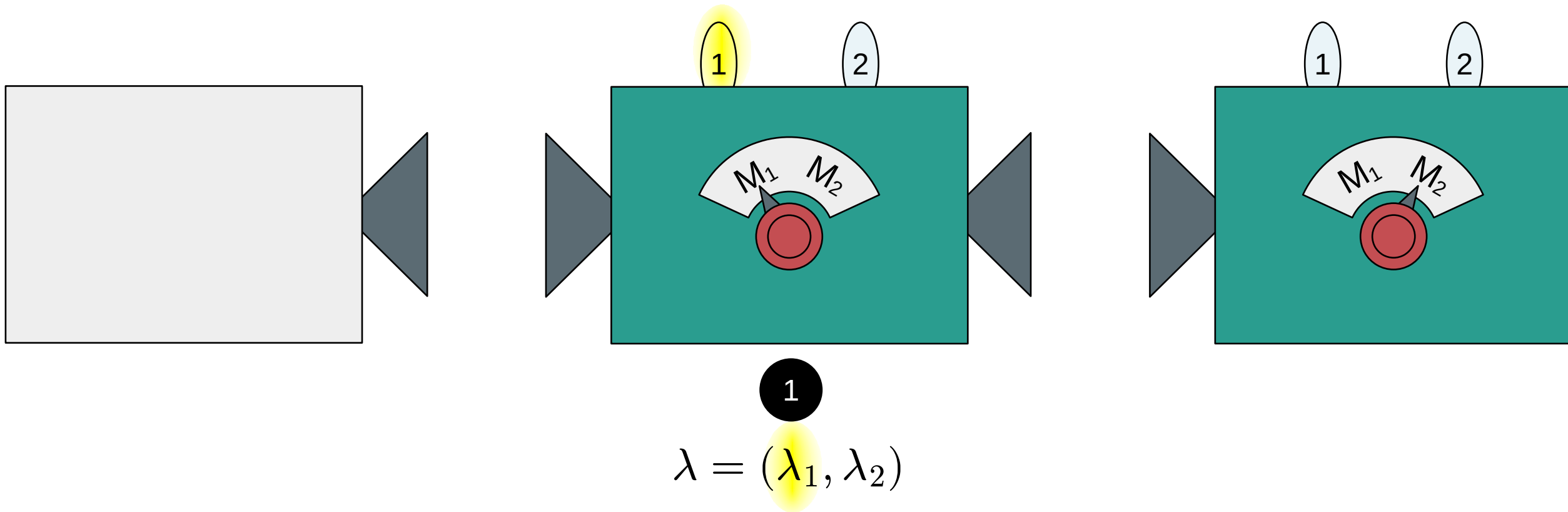


Sequential (or simultaneous) measurement

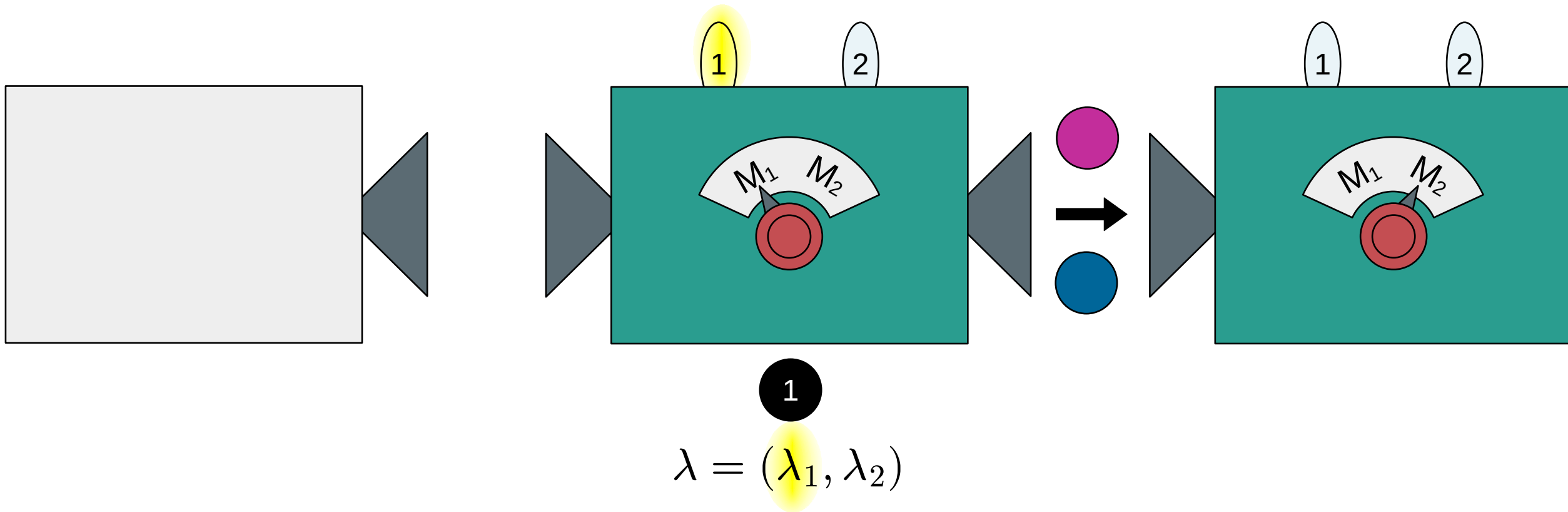


$$\lambda = (\lambda_1, \lambda_2)$$

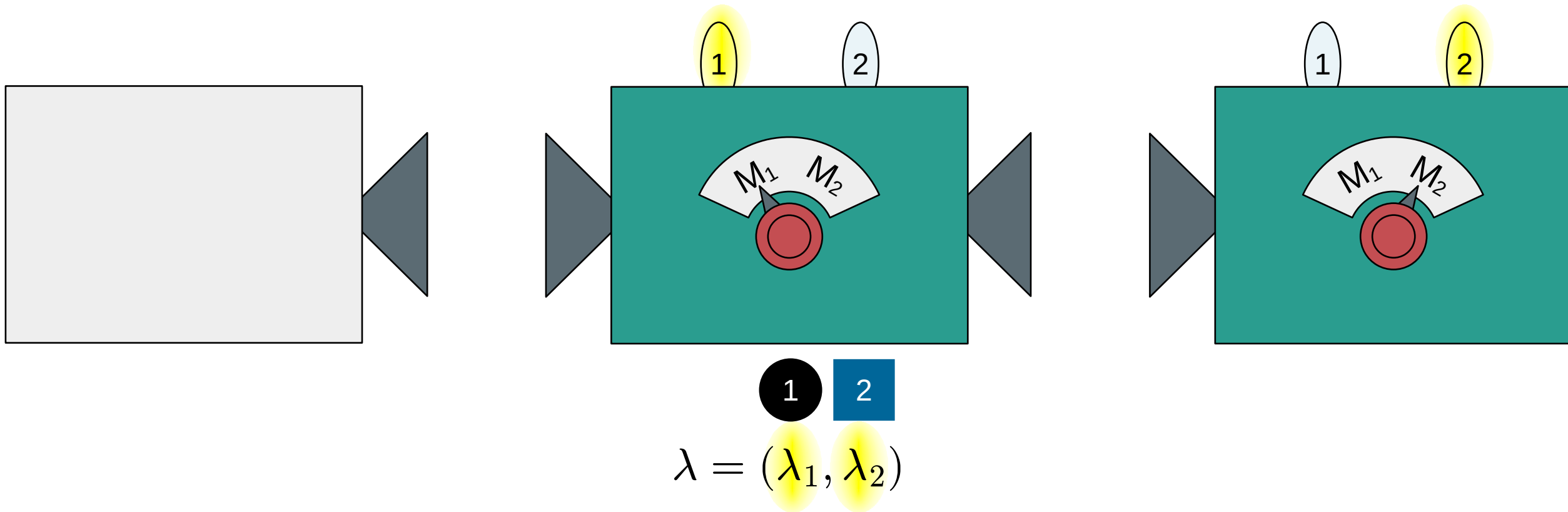
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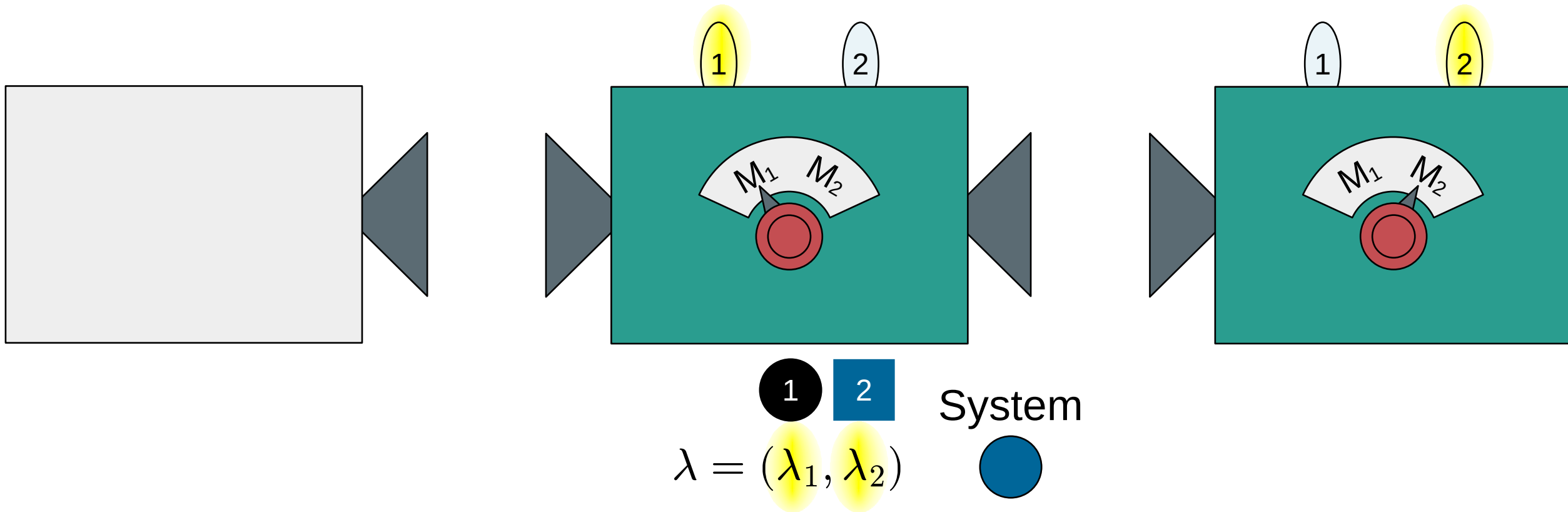
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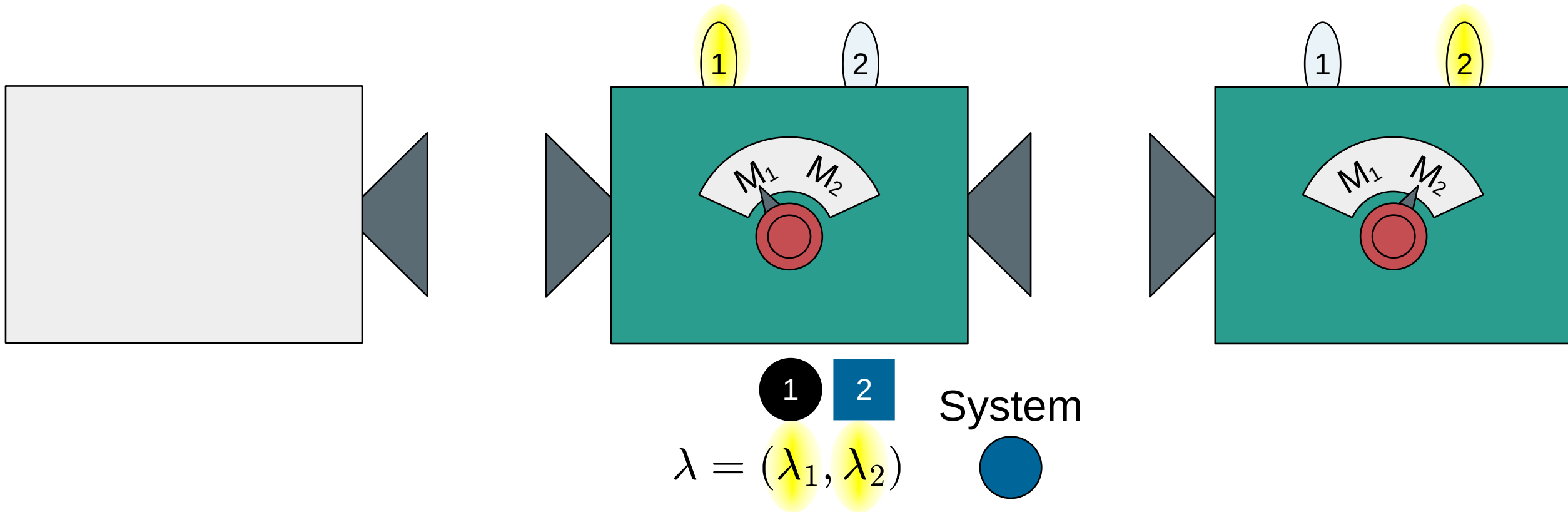
Sequential (or simultaneous) measurement



Sequential (or simultaneous) measurement



Sequential (or simultaneous) **non-disturbing** measurement



Outcome probabilities for non-disturbing measurements:

$$\text{Prob}(l, m, \dots | P, M_i, M_j, \dots) = \sum_{\lambda} \mu(\lambda | P) \xi(l | M_i, \lambda) \xi(m | M_j, \lambda) \dots$$

Outcome probabilities for non-disturbing measurements:

$$\text{Prob}(\underbrace{l, m, \dots}_k | P, \underbrace{M_i, M_j, \dots}_M) = \sum_{\lambda} \mu(\lambda | P) \underbrace{\xi(l | M_i, \lambda) \xi(m | M_j, \lambda) \dots}_{\xi(k | M, \lambda)}$$

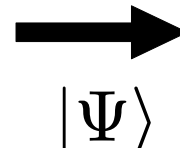
Outcome probabilities for non-disturbing measurements:

$$\text{Prob}(k|P, M) = \sum_{\lambda} \mu(\lambda|P) \xi(k|M, \lambda)$$

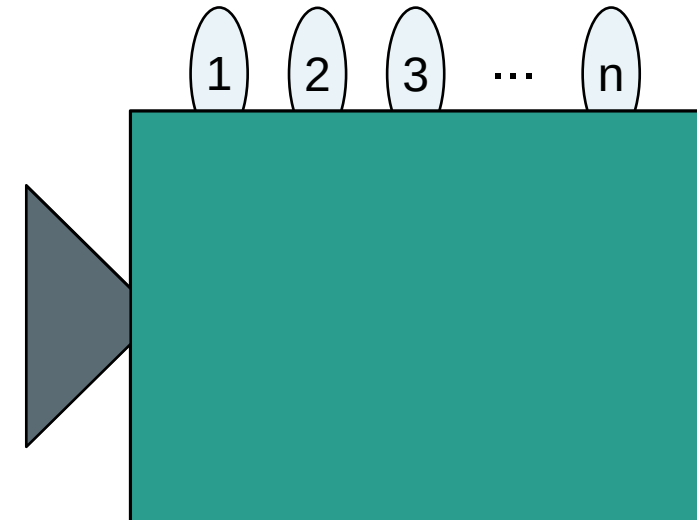
Preparation (P)



System



Measurement (M_j)

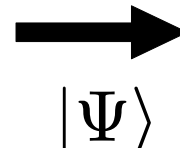


Set of undefined properties: $|\Psi\rangle = (|\psi_1\rangle, |\psi_2\rangle, |\psi_3\rangle, \dots)$

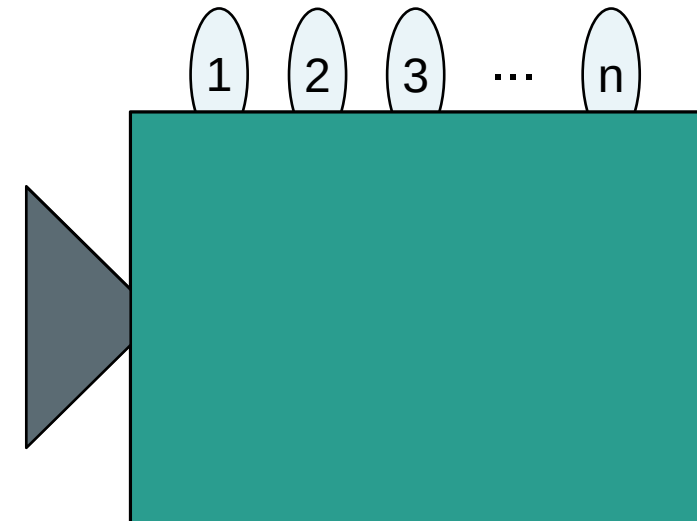
Preparation (P)



System



Measurement (M_j)



Set of undefined properties: $|\Psi\rangle = (|\psi_1\rangle, |\psi_2\rangle, |\psi_3\rangle, \dots)$

Superposition: $|\psi_j\rangle = a_1|1\rangle + a_2|2\rangle + a_3|3\rangle + \dots$

Pure state: $|\Psi\rangle$

Preparation (P)



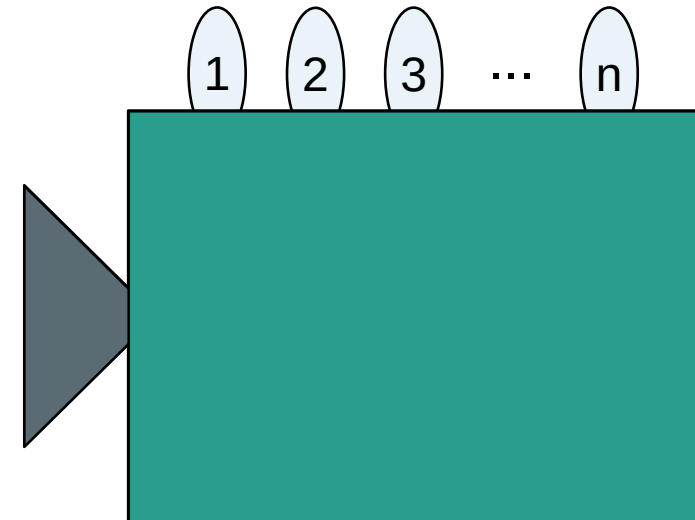
System



$|\Psi\rangle$

100%

Measurement (M_j)



Pure state: $|\Psi\rangle$

Projective measurement: $\hat{\Pi}_{k|M}$

Preparation (P)



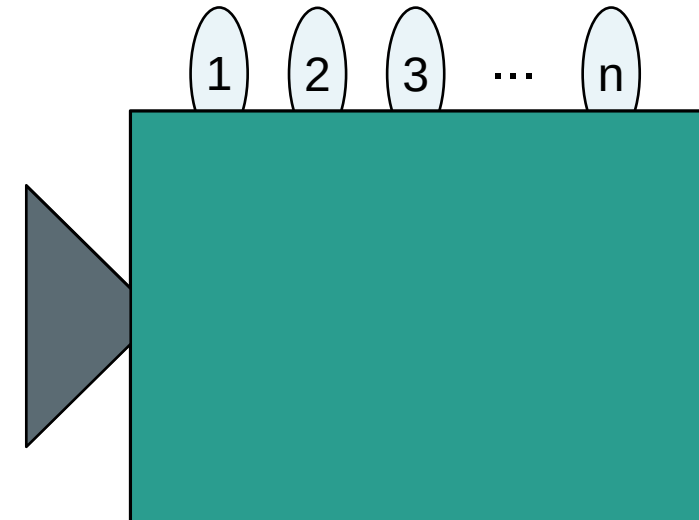
System



$|\Psi\rangle$

100%

Measurement (M_j)



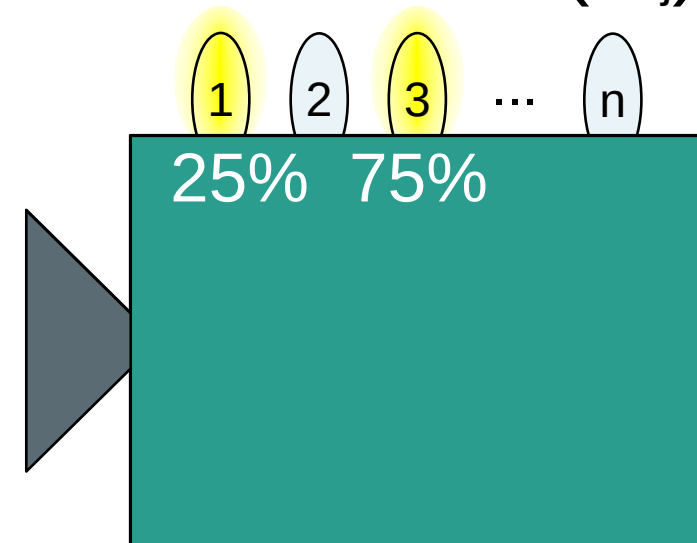
Pure state: $|\Psi\rangle$

Projective measurement: $\hat{\Pi}_{k|M}$

Preparation (P)



Measurement (M_j)



Outcome probabilities: $\text{Prob}(k|P, M) = \langle \Psi | \hat{\Pi}_{k|M} | \Psi \rangle \leq 1$

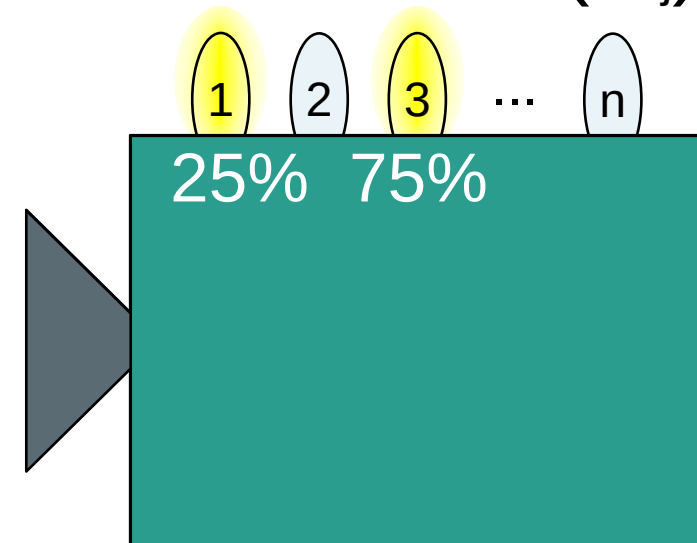
Pure state: $|\Psi\rangle$

Projective measurement: $\hat{\Pi}_{k|M}$

Preparation (P)



Measurement (M_j)



Is quantum mechanics secretly classical?

Outcome probabilities: $\text{Prob}(k|P, M) = \langle \Psi | \hat{\Pi}_{k|M} | \Psi \rangle \leq 1$

Pure state: $|\Psi\rangle$

Preparation (P)



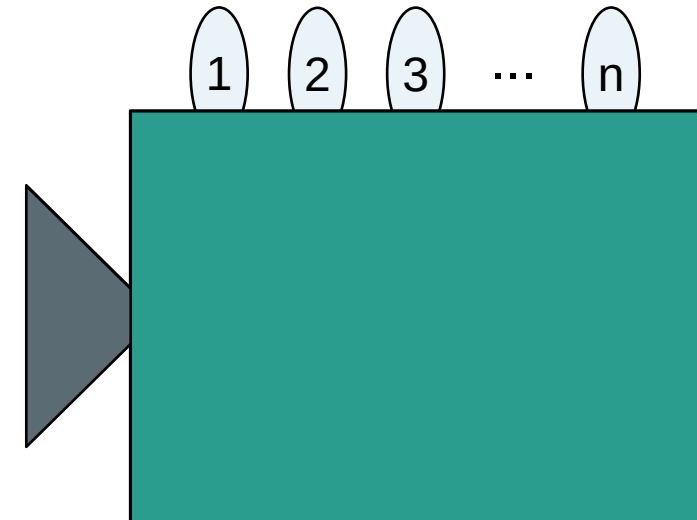
System



$|\Psi\rangle$

100%

Measurement (M_j)



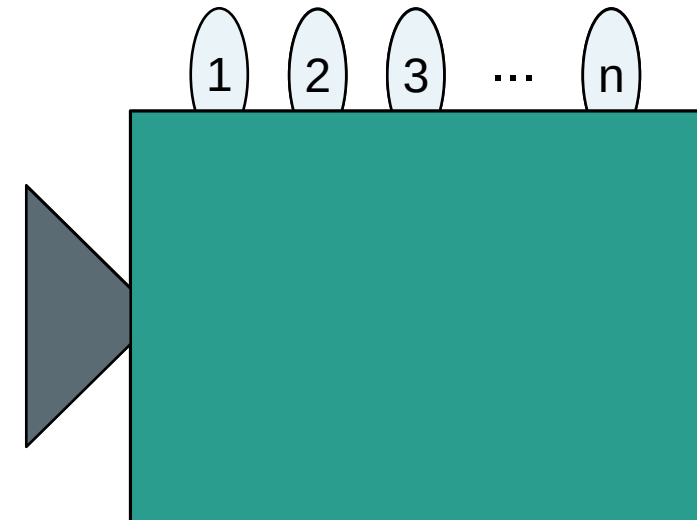
Probability distribution: $\mu(\lambda|P_i)$

Preparation (P)

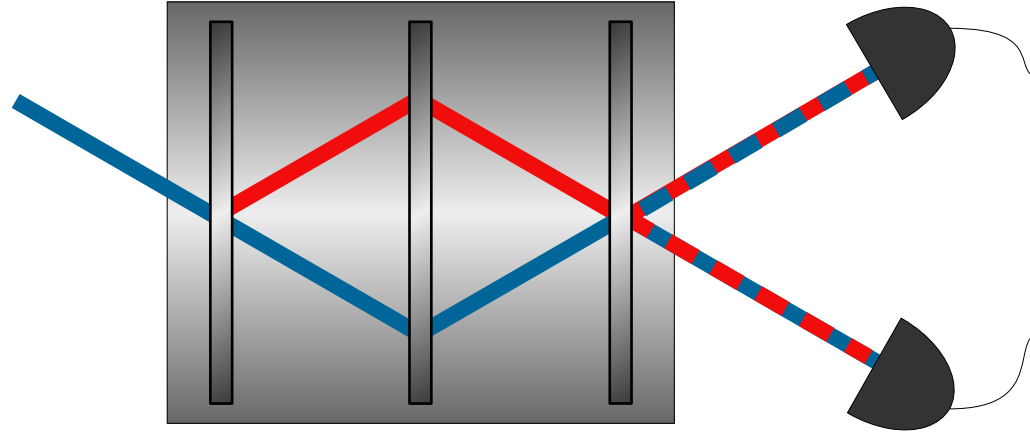


System
→
 λ' λ''
75% 25%

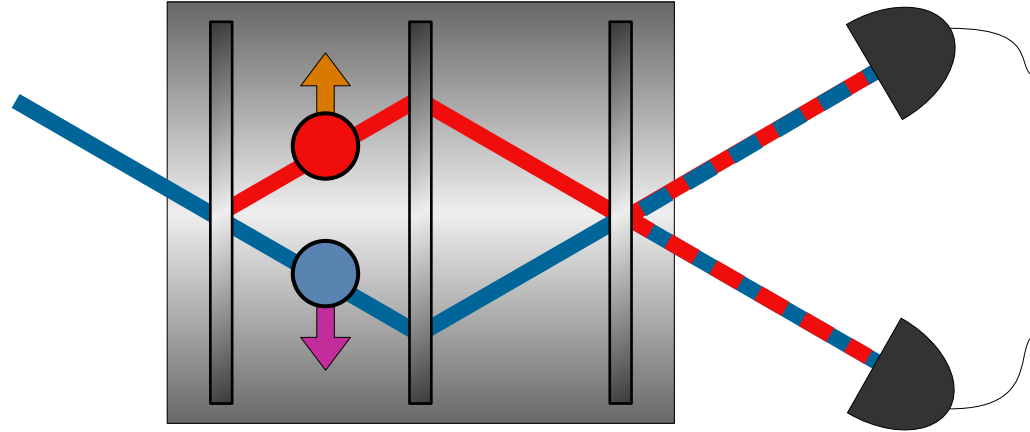
Measurement (M_j)



Neutron
Interferometer:



Neutron
Interferometer:

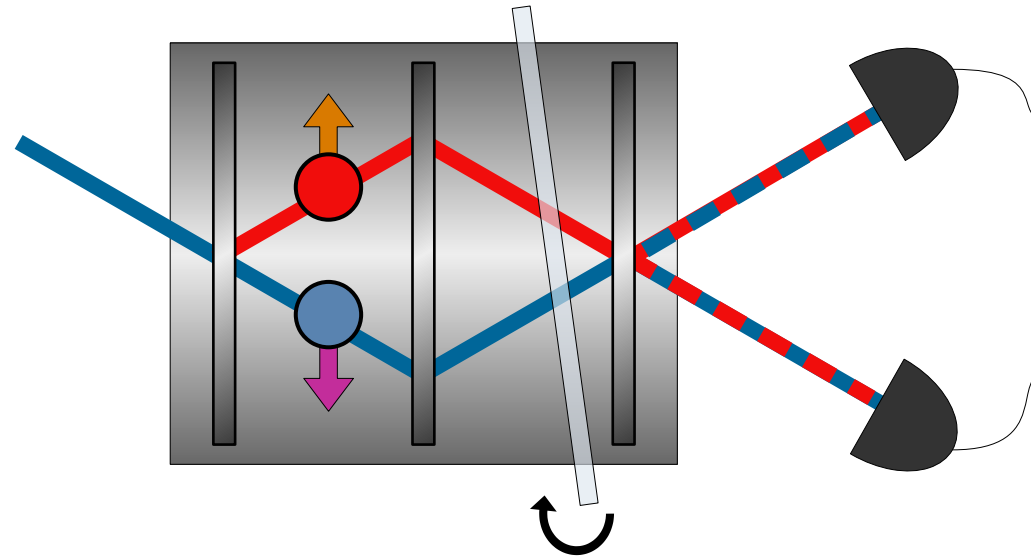


$$|\Psi\rangle = \frac{|1\rangle|\uparrow_z\rangle + |2\rangle|\downarrow_z\rangle}{\sqrt{2}}$$

Preparation (P)

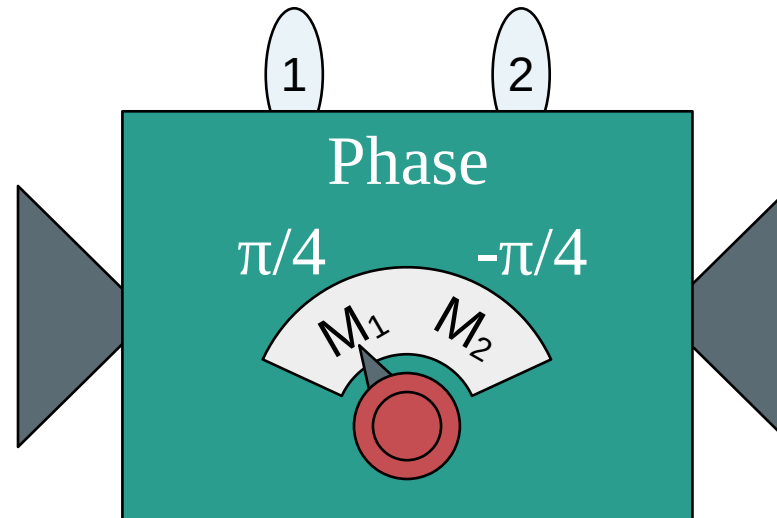
Neutron interferometry test of nonclassicality

Neutron
Interferometer:



$$|\Psi\rangle = \frac{|1\rangle|\uparrow_z\rangle + |2\rangle|\downarrow_z\rangle}{\sqrt{2}}$$

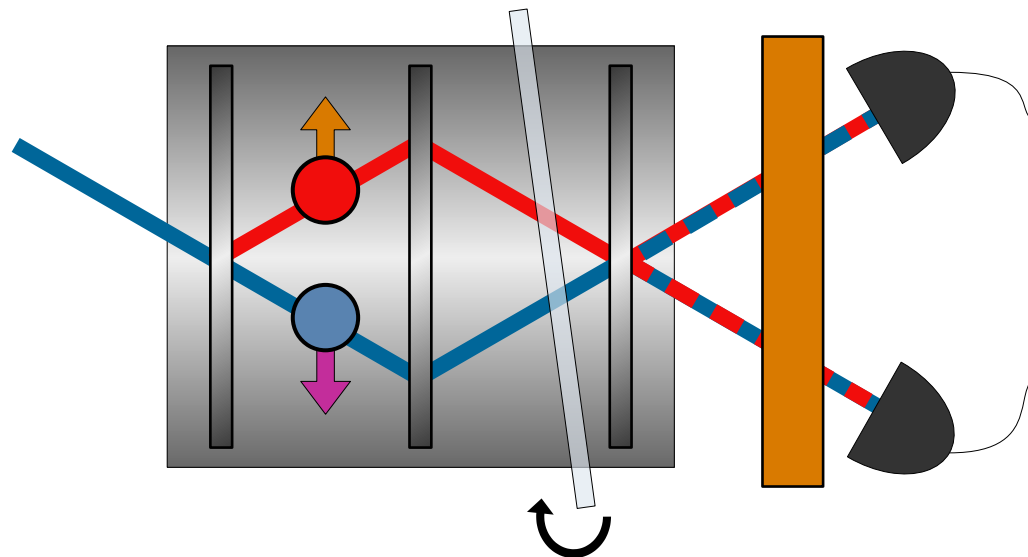
Preparation (P)



Path (M_1, M_2)

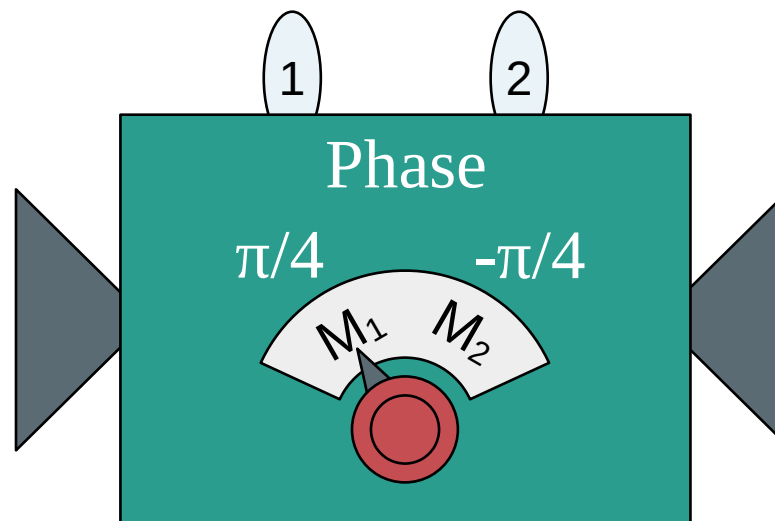
Neutron interferometry test of nonclassicality

Neutron
Interferometer:

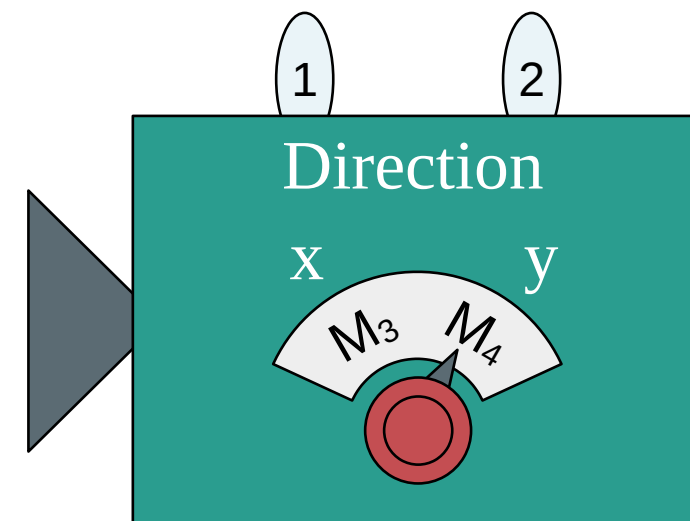


$$|\Psi\rangle = \frac{|1\rangle|\uparrow_z\rangle + |2\rangle|\downarrow_z\rangle}{\sqrt{2}}$$

Preparation (P)



Path (M_1, M_2)



Spin (M_3, M_4)₅₈

Neutron interferometry test of nonclassicality

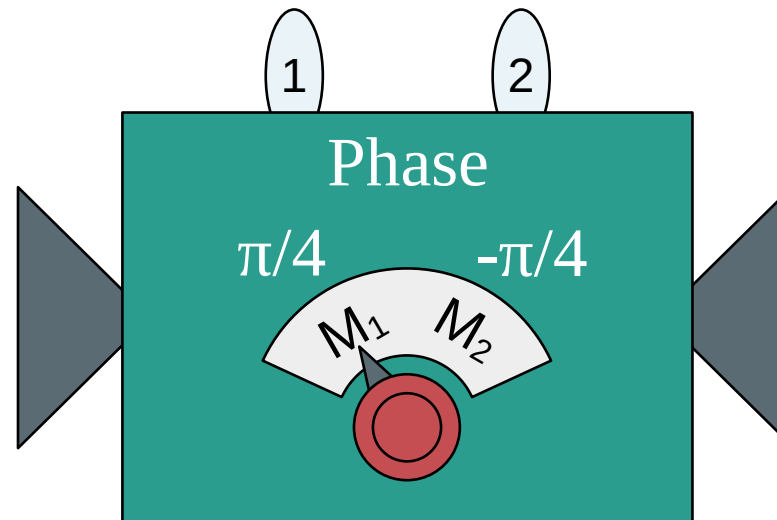
Measurements:

M_1 M_2

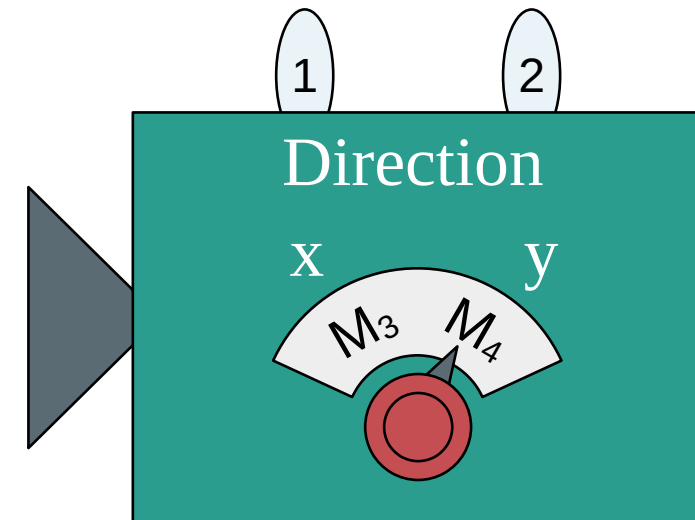
M_3 M_4

$$|\Psi\rangle = \frac{|1\rangle|\uparrow_z\rangle + |2\rangle|\downarrow_z\rangle}{\sqrt{2}}$$

Preparation (P)



Path (M_1, M_2)



Spin (M_3, M_4)

Neutron interferometry test of nonclassicality

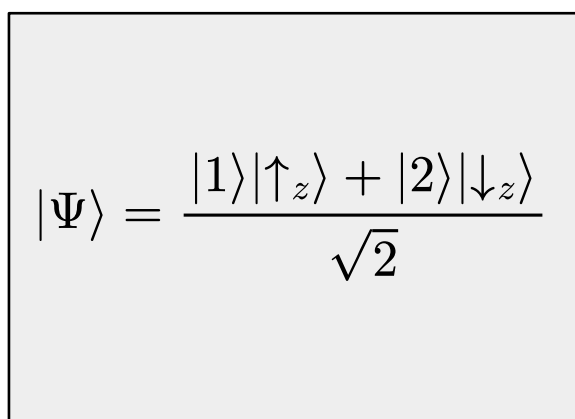
Measurements:

$M_1 \longleftrightarrow M_2$

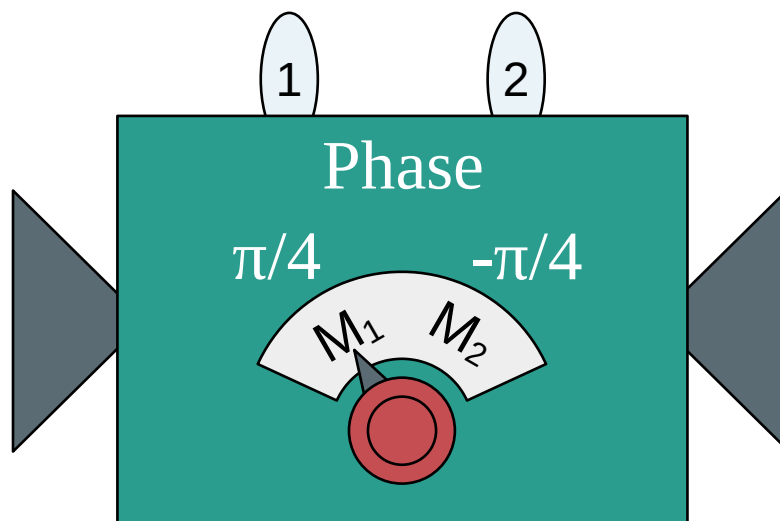
Disturbing
 $\longleftrightarrow$

$$[\hat{\Pi}_{k|M_i}, \hat{\Pi}_{l|M_j}] \neq 0$$

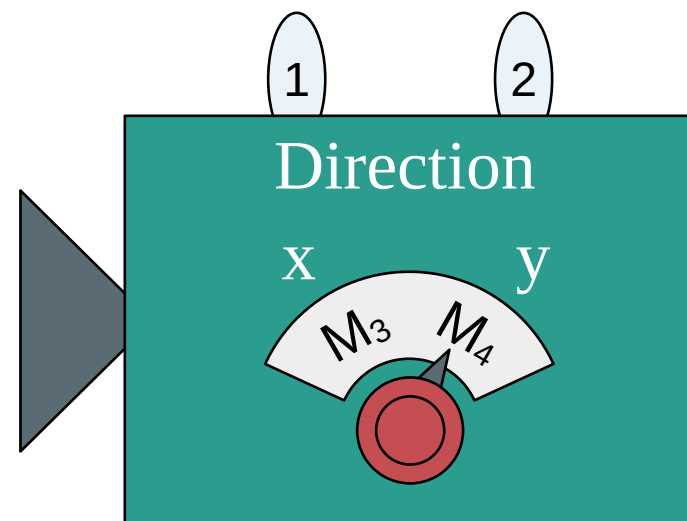
$M_3 \longleftrightarrow M_4$



Preparation (P)



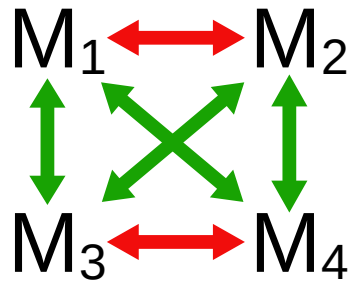
Path (M_1, M_2)



Spin (M_3, M_4)

Neutron interferometry test of nonclassicality

Measurements:

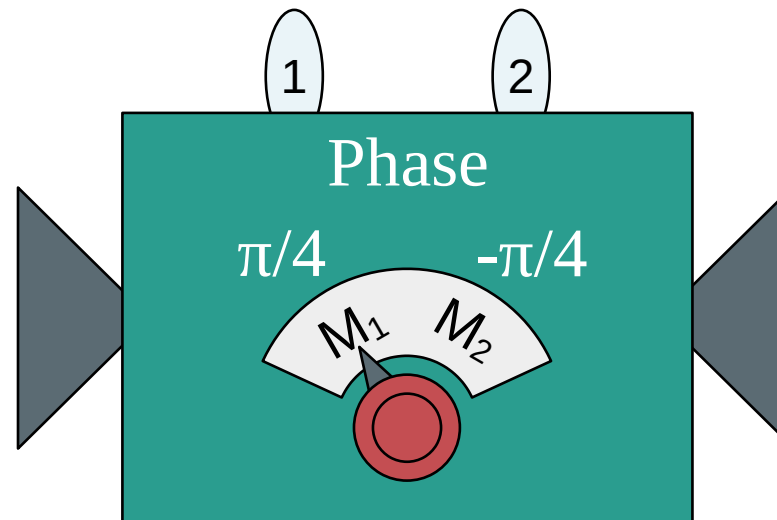


Disturbing
Non-disturbing

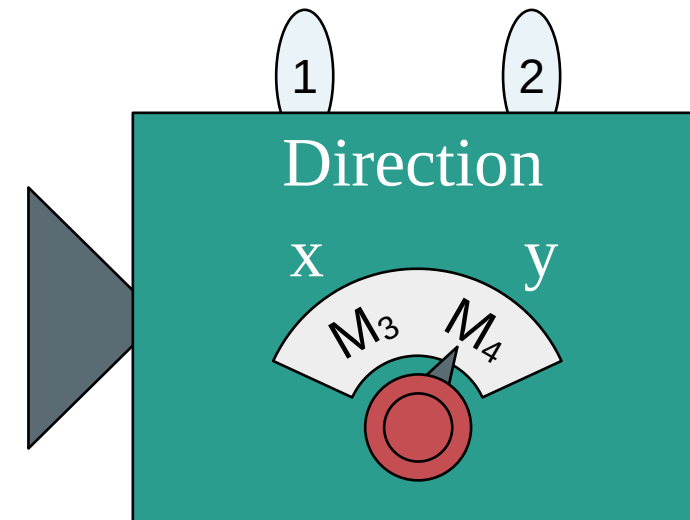
$$\begin{aligned} [\hat{\Pi}_{k|M_i}, \hat{\Pi}_{l|M_j}] &\neq 0 \\ [\hat{\Pi}_{k|M_i}, \hat{\Pi}_{l|M_j}] &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

$$|\Psi\rangle = \frac{|1\rangle|\uparrow_z\rangle + |2\rangle|\downarrow_z\rangle}{\sqrt{2}}$$

Preparation (P)



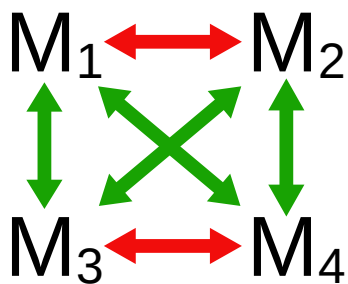
Path (M_1, M_2)



Spin (M_3, M_4)

Neutron interferometry test of nonclassicality

Measurements:

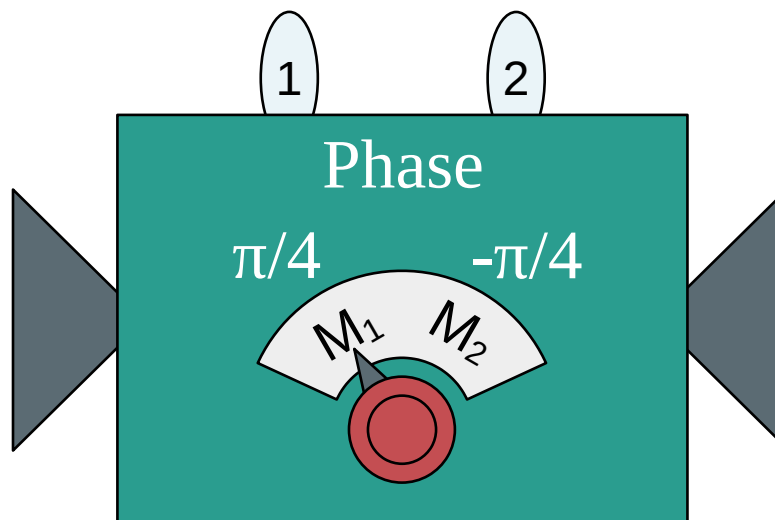


Disturbing
Non-disturbing

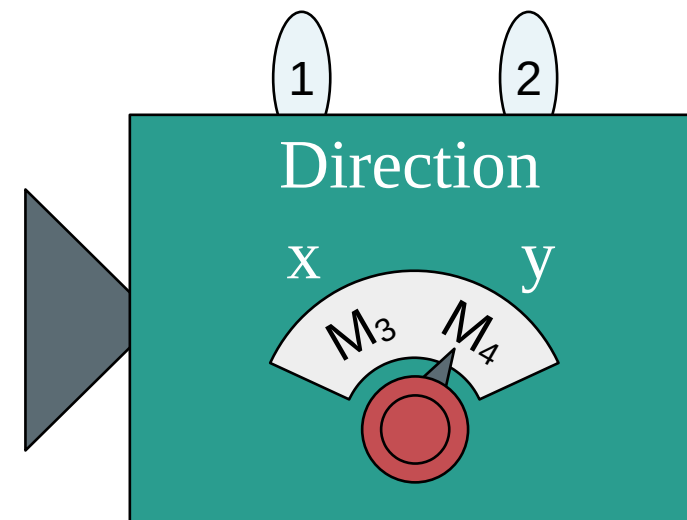
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$$|\Psi\rangle = \frac{|1\rangle|\uparrow_z\rangle + |2\rangle|\downarrow_z\rangle}{\sqrt{2}}$$

Preparation (P)



Path (M_1, M_2)



Spin (M_3, M_4)

Noncontextuality

Outcome probabilities:

$$\text{Prob}(k, l|P, M_i, M_j) = \langle \Psi | \hat{\Pi}_{k|M_i} \hat{\Pi}_{l|M_j} | \Psi \rangle$$

$$\stackrel{?}{=} \sum_{\lambda} \mu(\lambda|P) \xi(k|M_i, \lambda) \xi(l|M_j, \lambda)$$

Outcomes correlations:

$$E(M_i, M_j) = \text{Prob}(k, k|P, M_i, M_j) - \text{Prob}(k, l \neq k|P, M_i, M_j)$$

Clauser–Horne–Shimony–Holt (CHSH) inequality:

$$E(M_1, M_3) - E(M_1, M_4) + E(M_2, M_3) + E(M_2, M_4) \leq 2$$

J.F. Clauser; M.A. Horne; A. Shimony; R.A. Holt (1969), "Proposed experiment to test local hidden-variable theories", Phys. Rev. Lett., 23 (15): 880–4,

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Experimental results:

$$2.051 \pm 0.0019$$

Hasegawa, Yuji, et al. "Violation of a bell-like inequality in single-neutron interferometry." Nature 425, 45–48 (2003).

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Hasegawa, Yuji, et al. "Violation of a bell-like inequality in single-neutron interferometry." *Nature* 425, 45–48 (2003).

$$2.365 \pm 0.0013$$

Geppert, Hermann, et al. "Improvement of the polarized neutron interferometer setup demonstrating violation of a Bell-like inequality." *Nuclear Instruments and Methods in Physics Research Section A* 763 (2014): 417-423.

Is quantum mechanics secretly classical?

...NO!

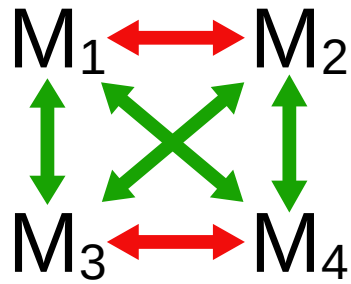
Is quantum mechanics secretly classical?

...NO!*

*according to our definition of non-disturbance (commutativity)

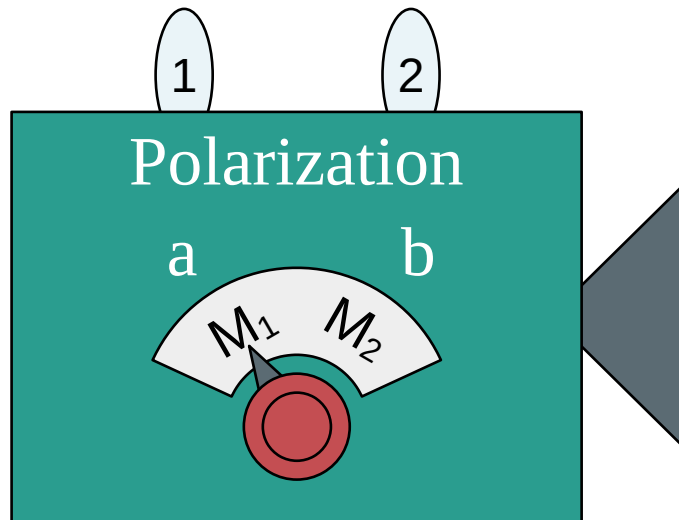
Bell test of nonclassicality

Measurements:

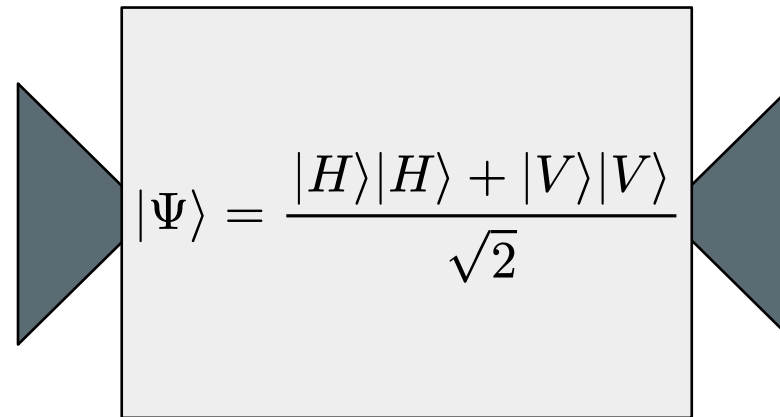


Disturbing
Non-disturbing

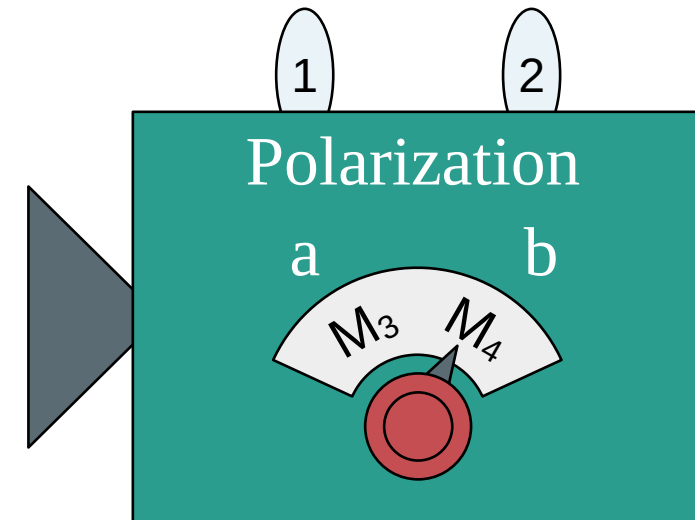
$$\begin{aligned} [\hat{\Pi}_{k|M_i}, \hat{\Pi}_{l|M_j}] &\neq 0 \\ [\hat{\Pi}_{k|M_i}, \hat{\Pi}_{l|M_j}] &= 0 \end{aligned}$$



Particle 1 (M_1, M_2)



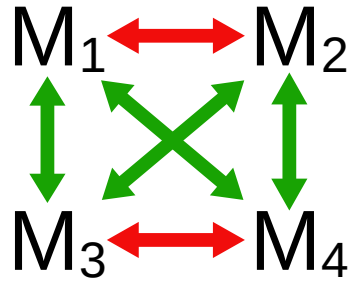
Preparation (P)



Particle 2 (M_3, M_4)

Bell test of nonclassicality

Measurements:



Disturbing

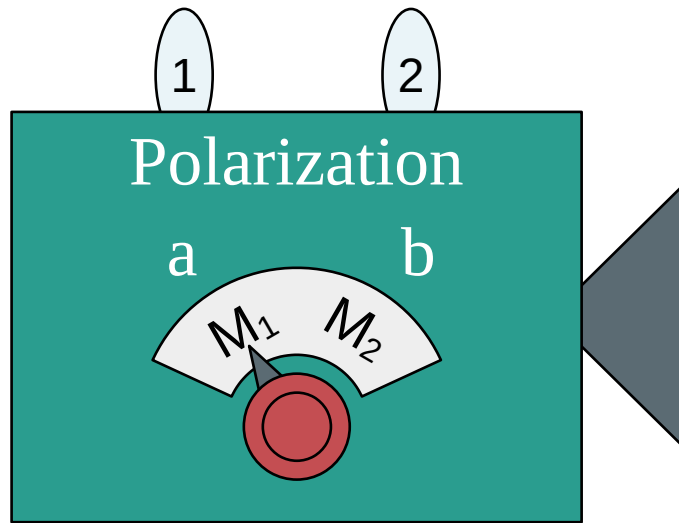


Non-disturbing

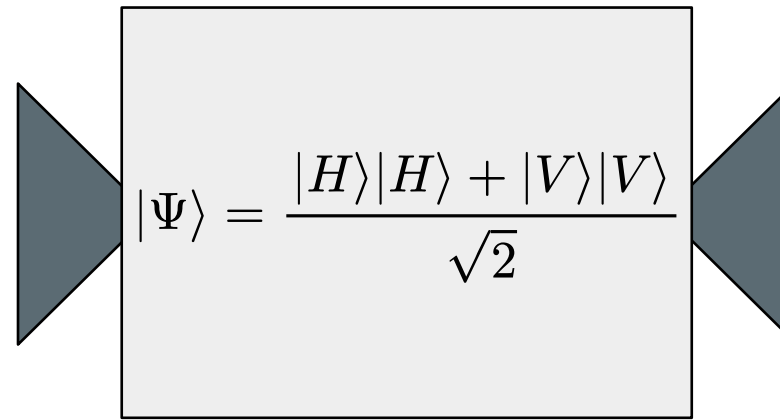


$$[\hat{\Pi}_{k|M_i}, \hat{\Pi}_{l|M_j}] \neq 0$$

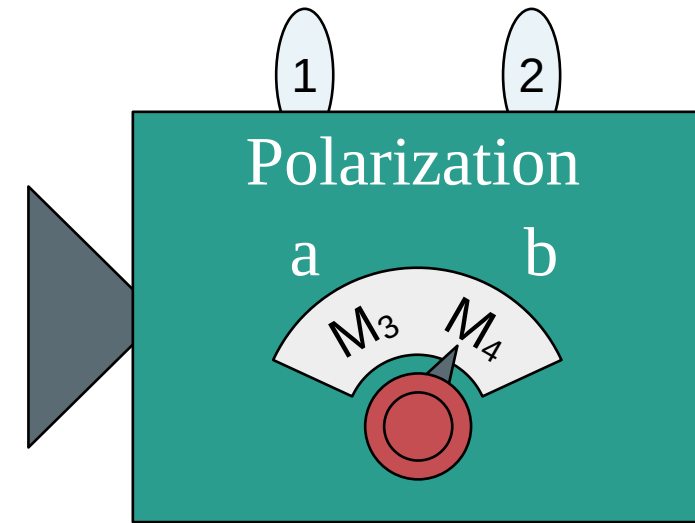
Separated in space!



Particle 1 (M_1, M_2)



Preparation (P)



Particle 2 (M_3, M_4)

Locality

Experimental result:

$$2.697 \pm 0.015 > 2$$

Aspect, Alain, et al. "Experimental realization of Einstein-Podolsky-Rosen-Bohm Gedankenexperiment: A new violation of Bell's inequalities." Physical review letters 49.2 (1982): 91.

Quantum mechanics seems to be nonclassical
independently of the quantum model

Questions?

Break

Outcome probabilities:

$$\text{Prob}(k|P, M) = \langle \Psi | \hat{\Pi}_{k|M} | \Psi \rangle \stackrel{?}{=} \sum_{\lambda} \mu(\lambda|P) \xi(k|M, \lambda)$$

Quasiprobability representations and weak values

Quasiprobability representations:

$$\text{Prob}(k|P, M) = \langle \Psi | \hat{\Pi}_{k|M} | \Psi \rangle = \sum_{\lambda} \tilde{\mu}(\lambda|P) \tilde{\xi}(k|\lambda, M)$$

Quasiprobability representations:

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Anomalous features:

$$\tilde{\mu}(\lambda|\Psi), \tilde{\xi}(k|\lambda, \hat{\Pi}_{k|M}) < 0$$

$$\tilde{\xi}(k|\lambda, \hat{\Pi}_{k|M}) > 1$$

$$\tilde{\mu}(\lambda|\Psi), \tilde{\xi}(k|\lambda, \hat{\Pi}_{k|M}) \in \mathbb{C}$$

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Ferrie, Christopher. "Quasi-probability representations of quantum theory with applications to quantum information science." Reports on Progress in Physics 74.11 (2011): 116001.

Spekkens, Robert W. "Negativity and contextuality are equivalent notions of nonclassicality." Physical review letters 101.2 (2008): 020401.

Quasiprobability representations:

Quasiprobability
distribution

$$\text{Prob}(k|P, M) = \langle \Psi | \hat{\Pi}_{k|M} | \Psi \rangle = \sum_{\lambda} \tilde{\mu}(\lambda|P) \tilde{\xi}(k|\lambda, M)$$

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$$\text{Prob}(k|P, M) = \langle \Psi | \hat{\Pi}_{k|M} | \Psi \rangle = \sum_{\lambda} \overset{\text{Quasiprobability distribution}}{\tilde{\mu}(\lambda|P)} \underset{\text{Symbol}}{\tilde{\xi}(k|\lambda, M)}$$

Anomalous features:

$$\tilde{\mu}(\lambda|\Psi), \tilde{\xi}(k|\lambda, \hat{\Pi}_{k|M}) < 0$$

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$$\tilde{\mu}(\lambda|\Psi), \tilde{\xi}(k|\lambda, \hat{\Pi}_{k|M}) \in \mathbb{C}$$

Two orthonormal basis: $\{|a_i\rangle\}, \{|b_j\rangle\}$

Kirkwood-Dirac quasiprobability representation:

$$\text{Prob}(k|P, M) = \langle \Psi | \hat{\Pi}_{k|M} | \Psi \rangle = \sum_{a_i, b_j} \langle \Psi | b_j \rangle \langle b_j | a_i \rangle \langle a_i | \Psi \rangle \frac{\langle b_j | \hat{\Pi}_{k|M} | a_i \rangle}{\langle b_j | a_i \rangle}$$

Two orthonormal basis: $\{|a_i\rangle\}, \{|b_j\rangle\}$

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Weak value

Two orthonormal basis: $\{|a_i\rangle\}, \{|b_j\rangle\}$

Kirkwood-Dirac quasiprobability representation:

$$\text{Prob}(k|P, M) = \langle \Psi | \hat{\Pi}_{k|M} | \Psi \rangle = \sum_{a_i, b_j} \langle \Psi | b_j \rangle \langle b_j | a_i \rangle \langle a_i | \Psi \rangle \frac{\langle b_j | \hat{\Pi}_{k|M} | a_i \rangle}{\langle b_j | a_i \rangle}$$

Weak value

..and we can measure it!

Two orthonormal basis: $\{|a_i\rangle\}, \{|b_j\rangle\}$

Kirkwood-Dirac quasiprobability representation:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Prob}(k|P, M) &= \langle \Psi | \hat{\Pi}_{k|M} | \Psi \rangle = \sum_{a_i, b_j} \langle \Psi | b_j \rangle \langle b_j | a_i \rangle \langle a_i | \Psi \rangle \frac{\langle b_j | \hat{\Pi}_{k|M} | a_i \rangle}{\langle b_j | a_i \rangle} \\ &= \sum_{a_i, b_j} |\langle b_j | \Psi \rangle|^2 \frac{\langle b_j | a_i \rangle \langle a_i | \Psi \rangle}{\langle b_j | \Psi \rangle} \frac{\langle b_j | \hat{\Pi}_{k|M} | a_i \rangle}{\langle b_j | a_i \rangle}\end{aligned}$$

Weak values!

..and we can measure them!

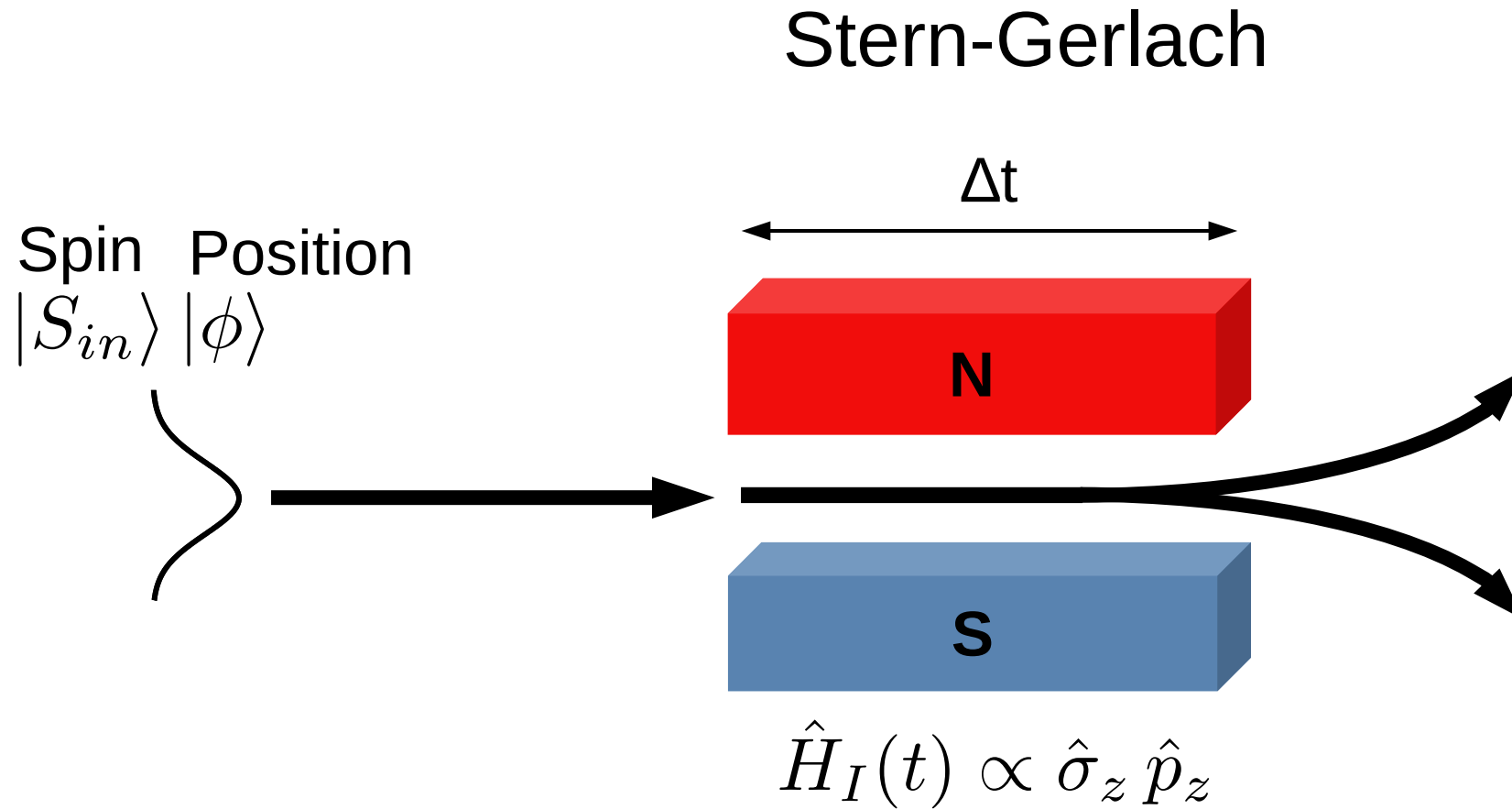
Stern-Gerlach

Spin Position

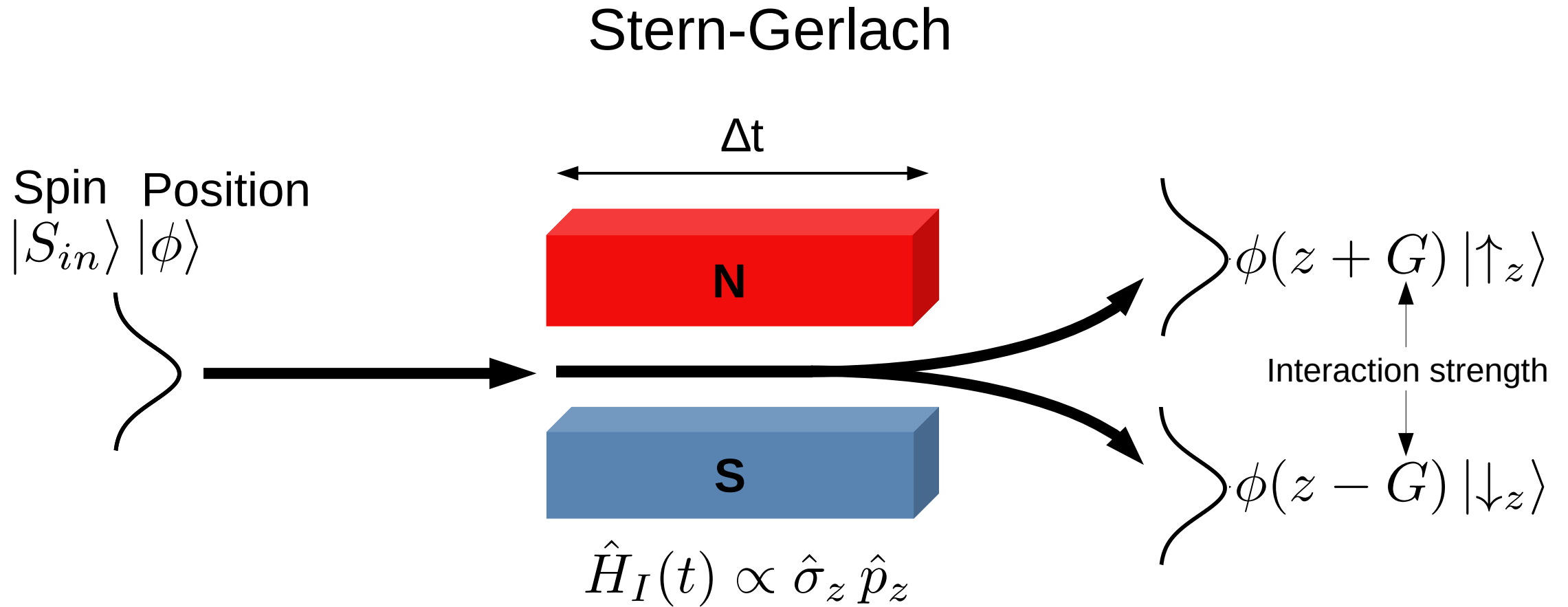
$|S_{in}\rangle |\phi\rangle$



A standard (Von Neumann) measurement

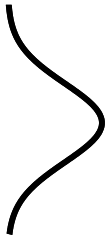


A standard (Von Neumann) measurement

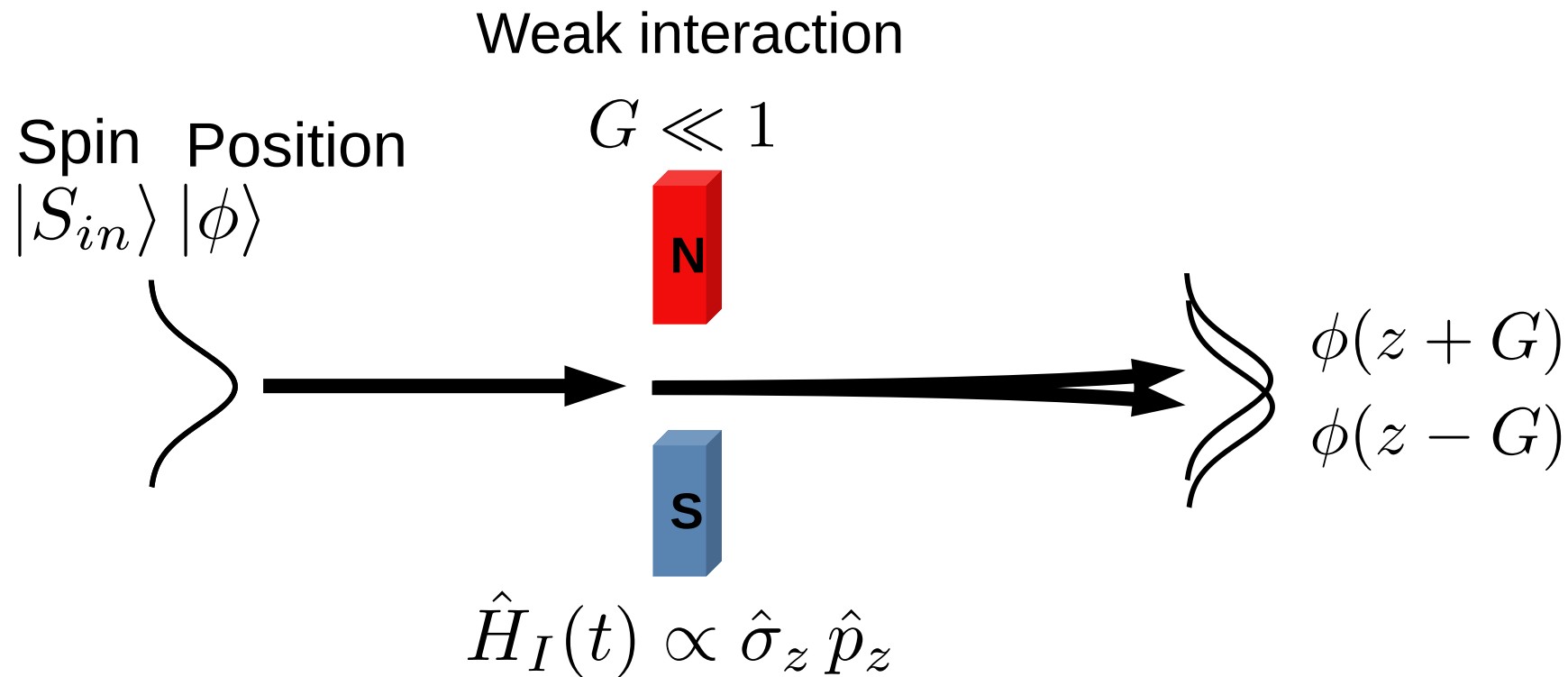


Spin Position

$|S_{in}\rangle$ $|\phi\rangle$

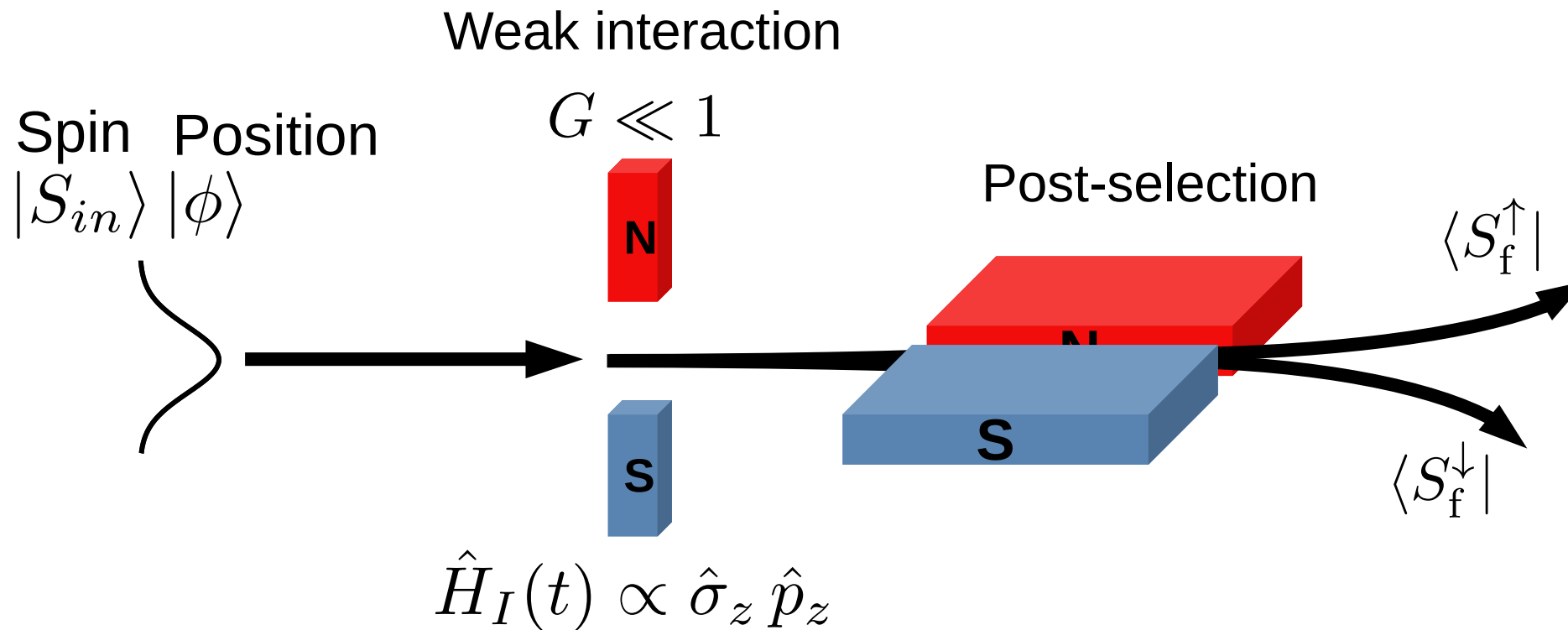


A weak measurement



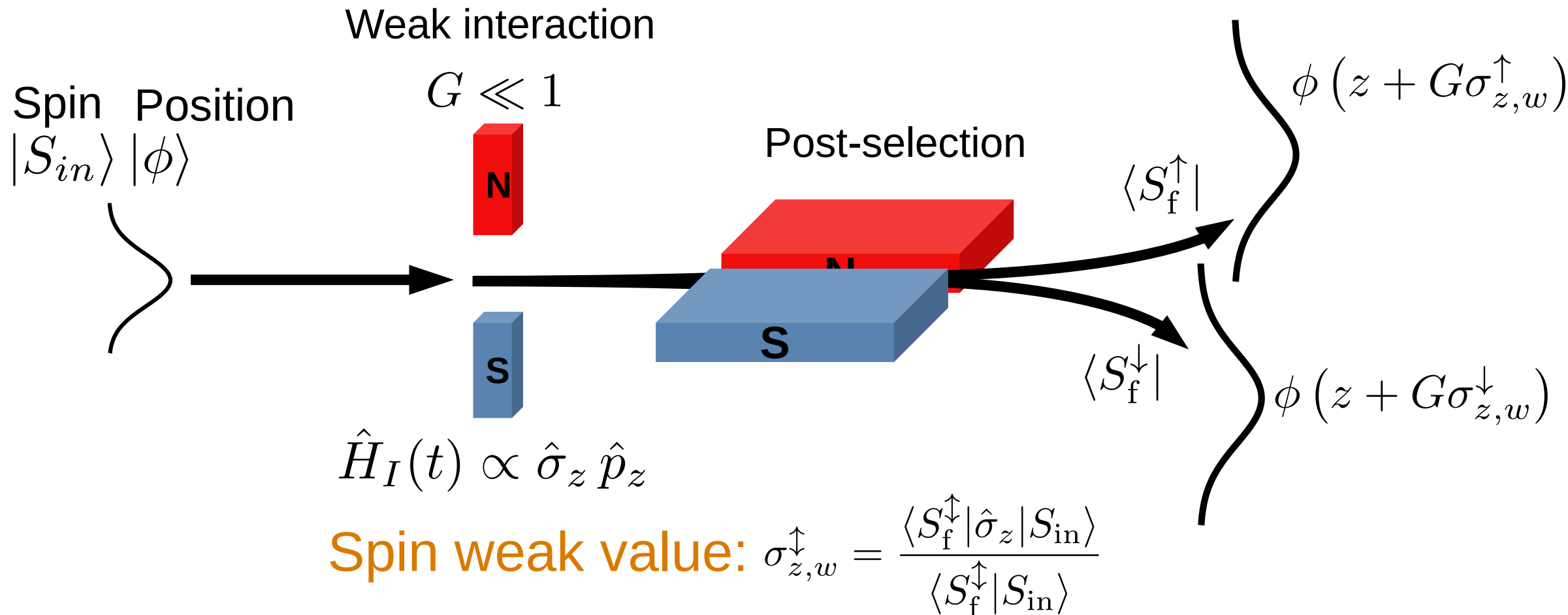
Aharonov, Yakir, et al. "How the result of a measurement of a component of the spin of a spin-1/2 particle can turn out to be 100." *Physical review letters* 60.14 (1988): 1351.

A weak measurement



Aharonov, Yakir, et al. "How the result of a measurement of a component of the spin of a spin-1/2 particle can turn out to be 100." *Physical review letters* 60.14 (1988): 1351.

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Meter state and weak interaction:

- Lemmel, Hartmut, et al. "Quantifying the presence of a neutron in the paths of an interferometer." *Physical Review Research* 4.2 (2022): 023075.
- Danner, Armin, et al. "Simultaneous path weak-measurements in neutron interferometry." *Scientific Reports* 14.1 (2024): 25994.
- Dvorak, Andreas, et al. "Tight qubit uncertainty relations studied through weak values in neutron interferometry." *Physical Review Research* 7.4 (2025): 043334.

Meter state and no weak interaction:

- Denkmayr, Tobias, et al. "Weak values from strong interactions in neutron interferometry." *Physica B: Condensed Matter* 551 (2018): 339-346.

No meter state and weak interaction:

- Masiello, Ismaele V., et al. "Simultaneous determination of two path weak-values with time-dependent phase manipulation in neutron interferometry." *New Journal of Physics* 27.2 (2025): 023017.

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Meter states or weak interactions increase
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The manipulation of additional degrees of freedom increases the amount of required experimental resources (additional instrumentation and procedures), while weak interactions typically necessitate longer measurement times due to the limited information gained per detection event.

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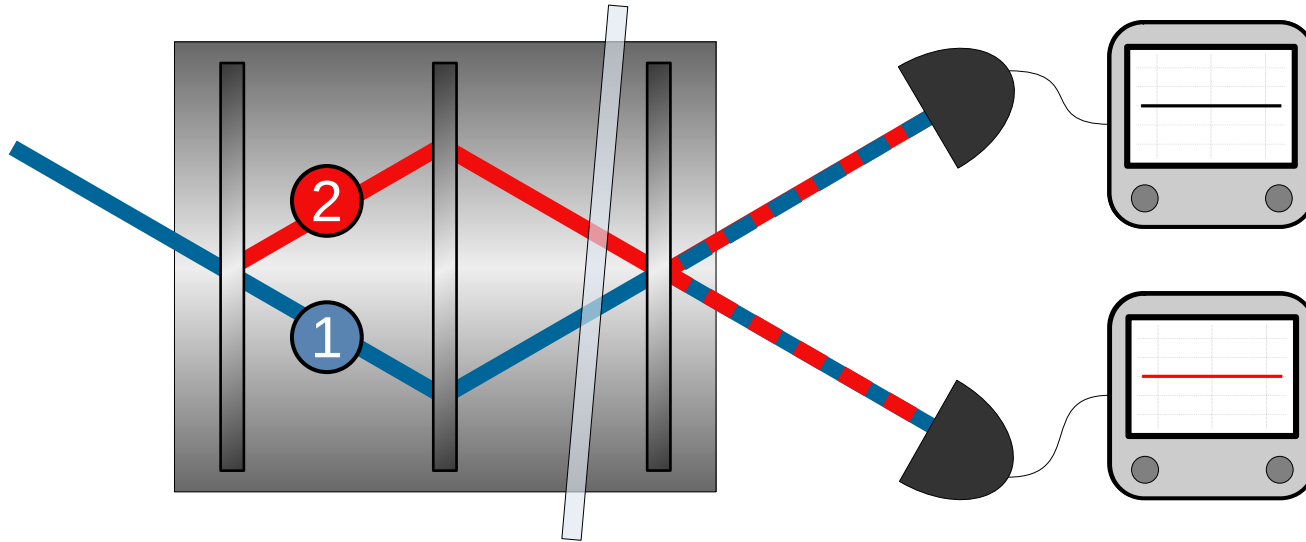
No meter state and no weak interaction:

- *Masiello, Ismaele V., et al. "Anomalous weak values in a generalized Mach-Zehnder interferometer extracted directly from intensity measurements." in review at npj Quantum Information.*

Unexpectedly running out of time :(

Brief experimental results

Neutron Mach-Zehnder interferometer:



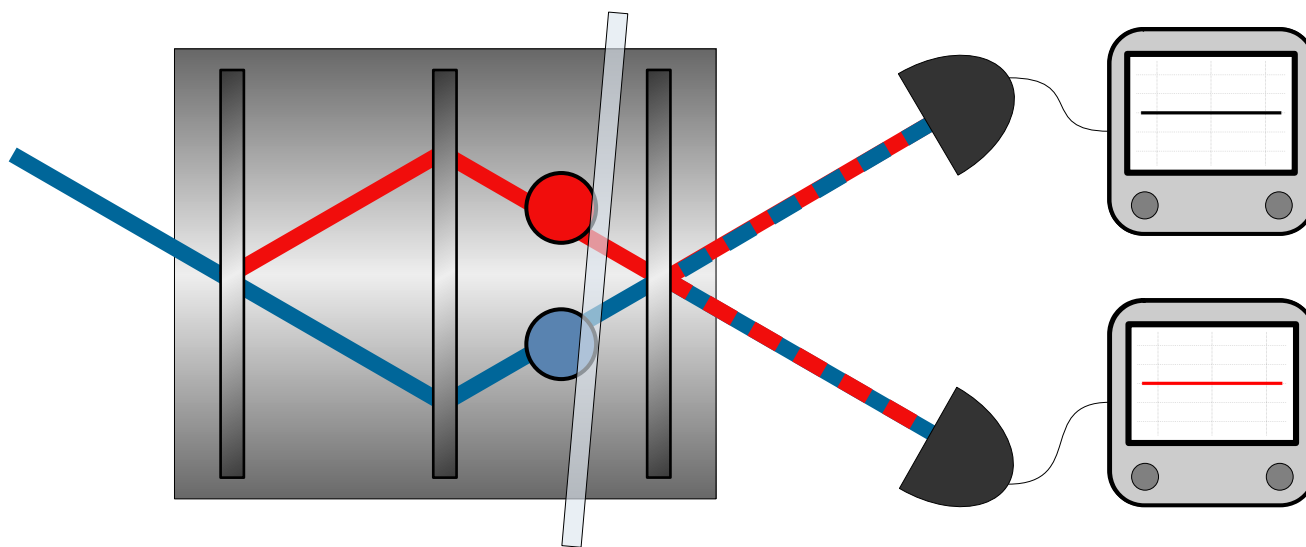
Initial state:

$$|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle = \cos\left(\frac{\theta}{2}\right)|1\rangle + e^{i\phi}\sin\left(\frac{\theta}{2}\right)|2\rangle$$

Path observable:

$$\hat{\Pi}_1 = |1\rangle\langle 1| \quad \hat{\Pi}_2 = |2\rangle\langle 2|$$

Generalized neutron Mach-Zehnder interferometer:



Initial state:

$$|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle = \cos\left(\frac{\theta}{2}\right)|1\rangle + e^{i\phi}\sin\left(\frac{\theta}{2}\right)|2\rangle$$

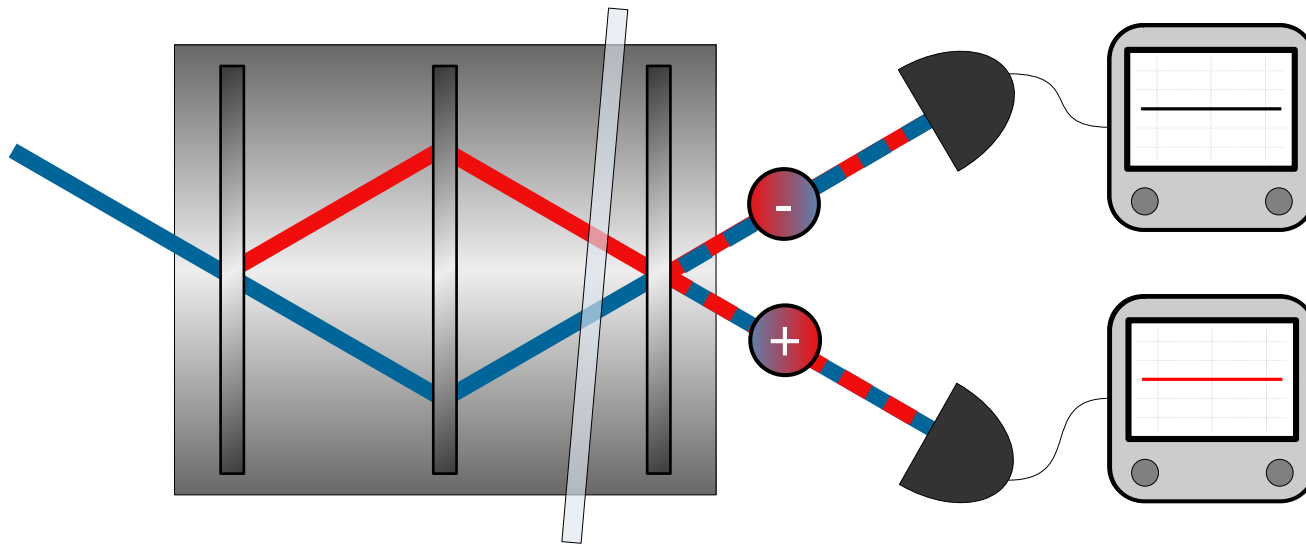
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$$|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle \rightarrow e^{-i\delta\hat{\Pi}_1}|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle$$

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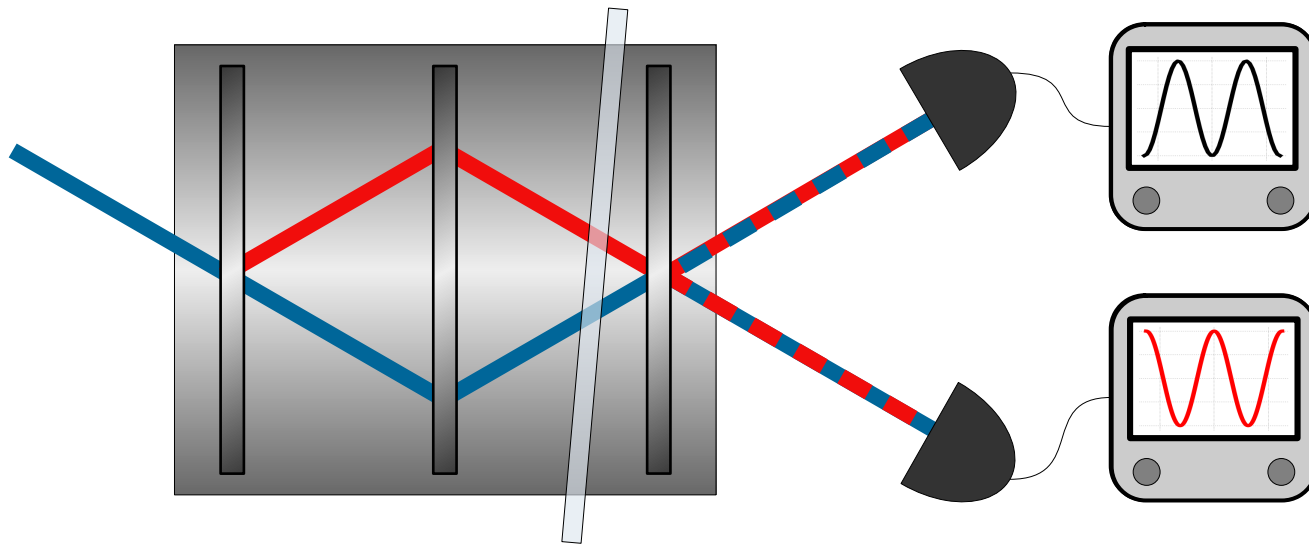
Phase shift:

$$|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle \rightarrow e^{-i\delta\hat{\Pi}_1}|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle$$

Final states:

$$|\psi_+\rangle = \frac{|1\rangle + |2\rangle}{\sqrt{2}} \quad |\psi_-\rangle = \frac{|1\rangle - |2\rangle}{\sqrt{2}}$$

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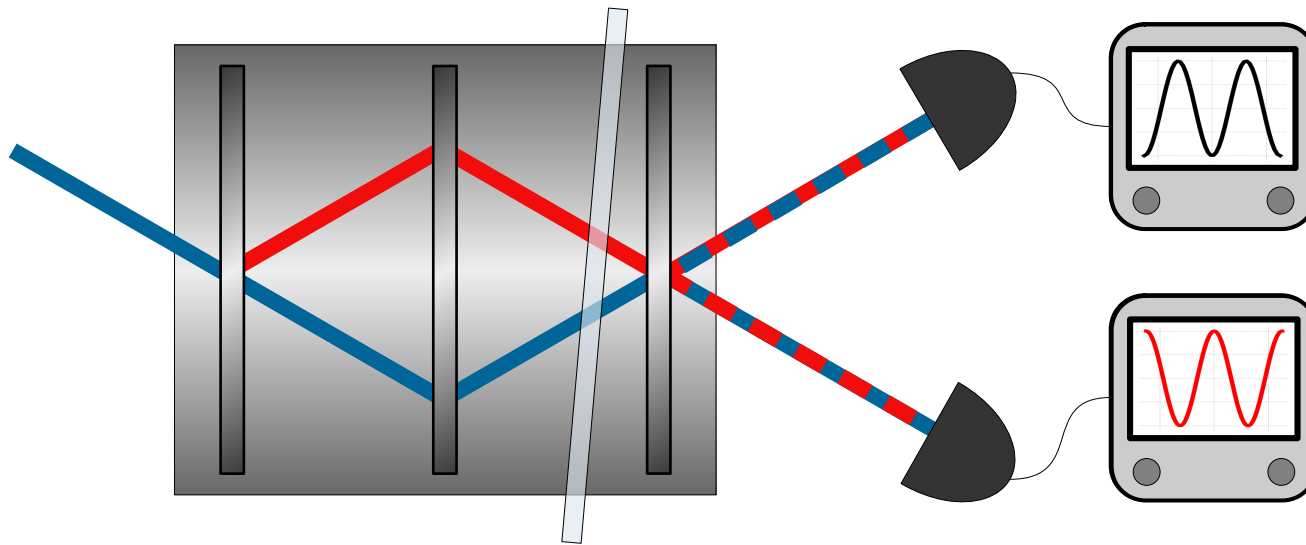
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Measured intensity:

$$I_{\pm}(\delta) = A \left[\frac{1}{2} \pm \frac{1}{2} \sin \theta \cos (\phi + \delta) \right]$$

Generalized neutron Mach-Zehnder interferometer:



Path weak-values:

$$w_{\pm,j} = \frac{\langle \psi_{\pm} | \hat{\Pi}_j | \psi_{\text{in}} \rangle}{\langle \psi_{\pm} | \psi_{\text{in}} \rangle} = w_{\pm,j}^{\text{R}} + i w_{\pm,j}^{\text{I}}$$

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$$|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle = \cos\left(\frac{\theta}{2}\right)|1\rangle + e^{i\phi} \sin\left(\frac{\theta}{2}\right)|2\rangle$$

Path observable:

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Phase shift:

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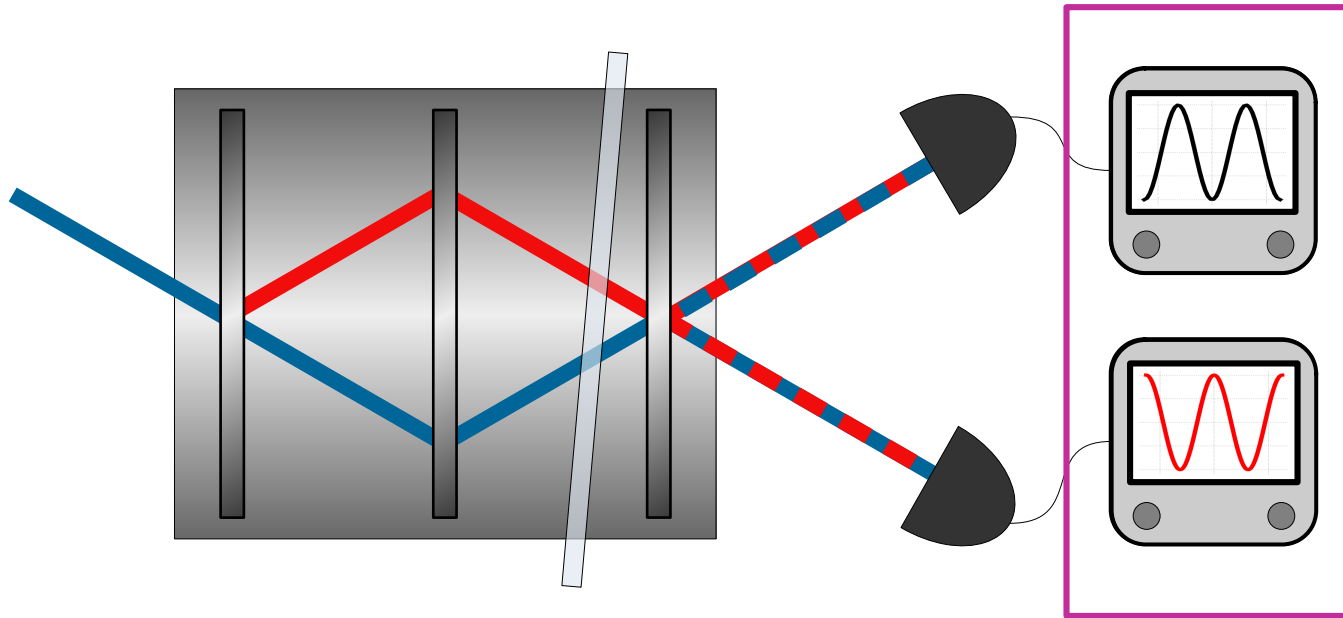
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Generalized neutron Mach-Zehnder interferometer:



Weak values can be
directly extracted from
the output intensities!

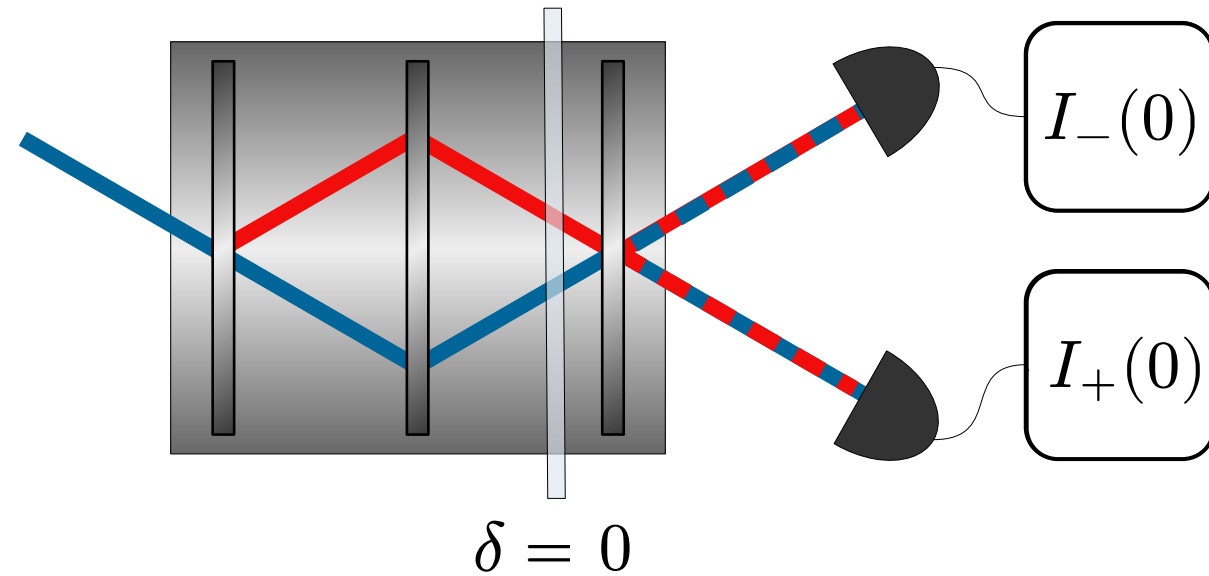
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$$w_{\pm,j} = \frac{\langle \psi_{\pm} | \hat{\Pi}_j | \psi_{\text{in}} \rangle}{\langle \psi_{\pm} | \psi_{\text{in}} \rangle} = w_{\pm,j}^{\text{R}} + i w_{\pm,j}^{\text{I}}$$

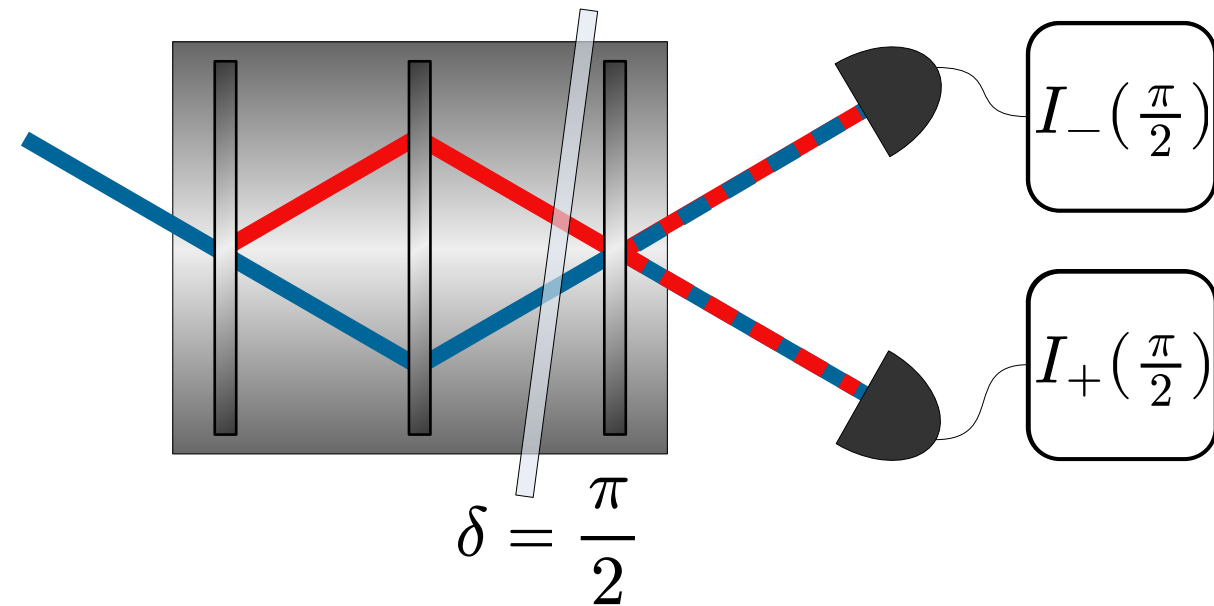
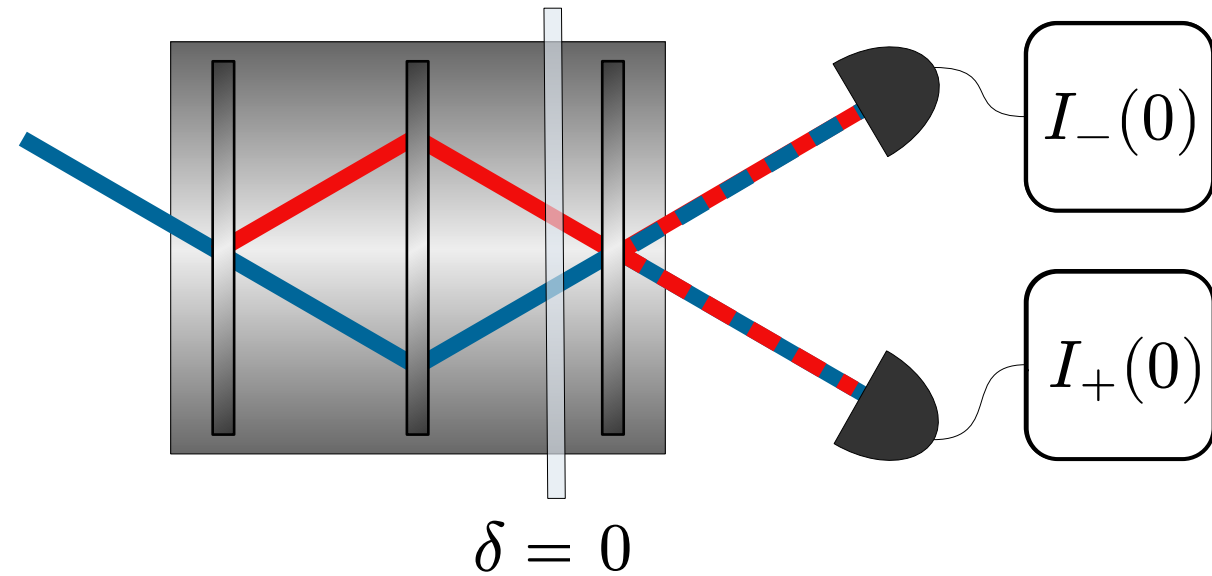
Measured intensity:

$$I_{\pm}(\delta) = A |\langle \psi_{\pm} | \psi_{\text{in}} \rangle|^2 \left[1 + 2 \left(\underbrace{|w_{\pm,1}|^2}_{\text{Amplitude squared}} - \underbrace{w_{\pm,1}^{\text{R}}}_{\text{Real part}} \right) (1 - \cos \delta) + 2 \underbrace{w_{\pm,1}^{\text{I}}}_{\text{Imaginary part}} \sin \delta \right]$$

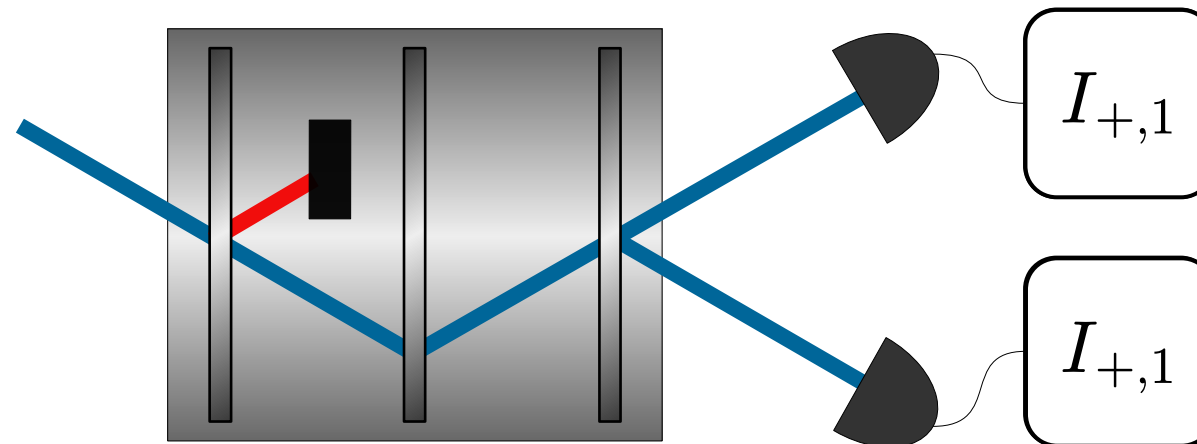
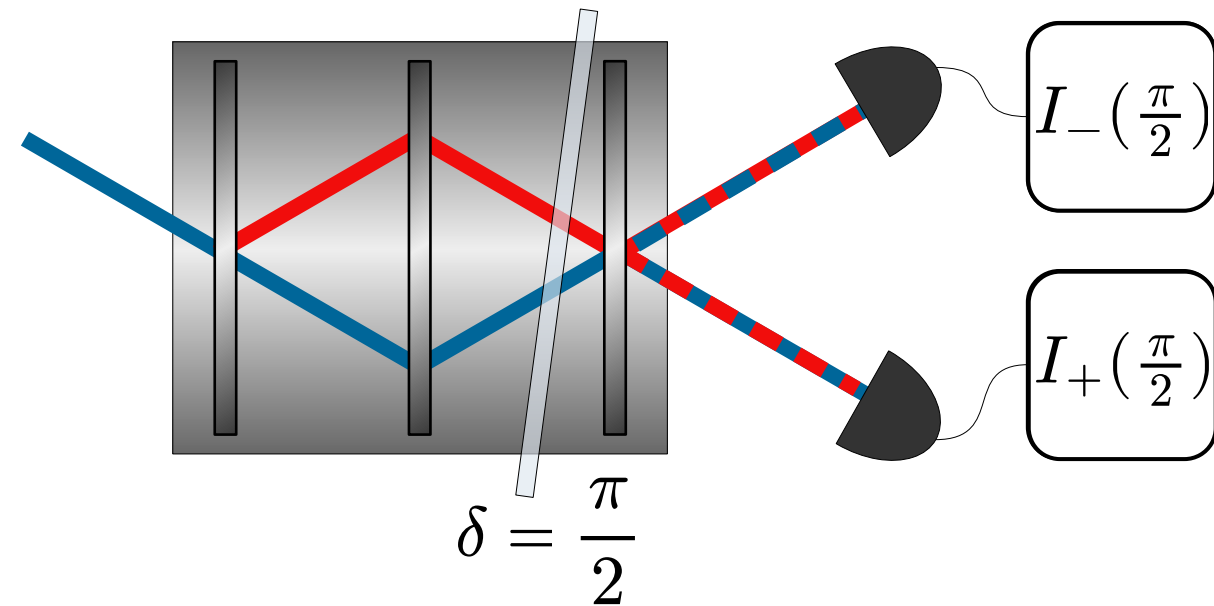
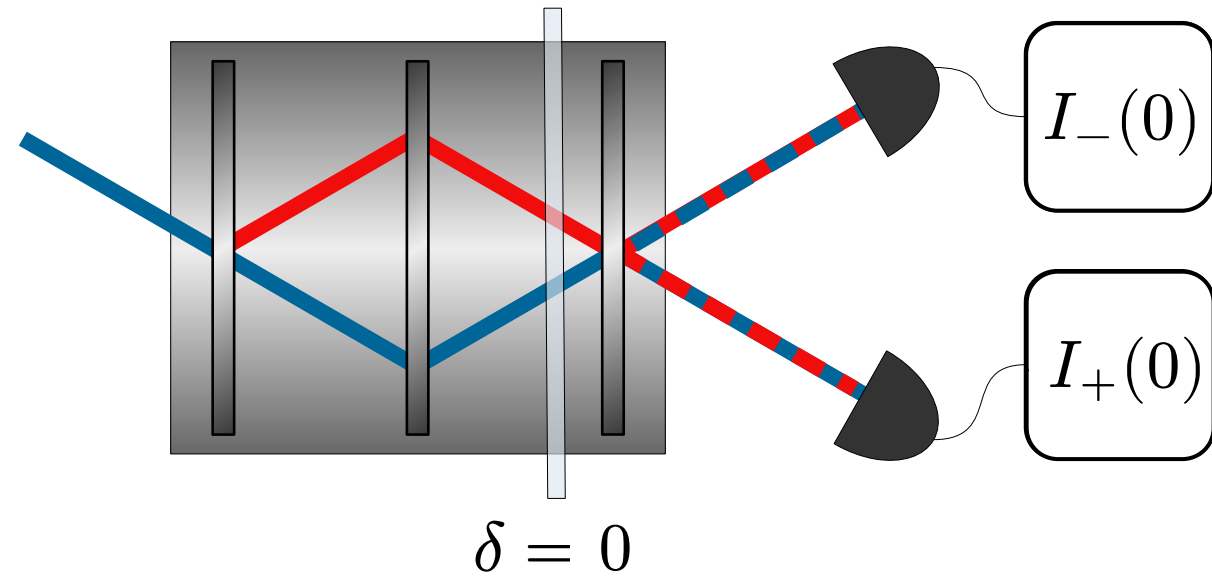
Three measurements settings:



Three measurements settings:



Three measurements settings:



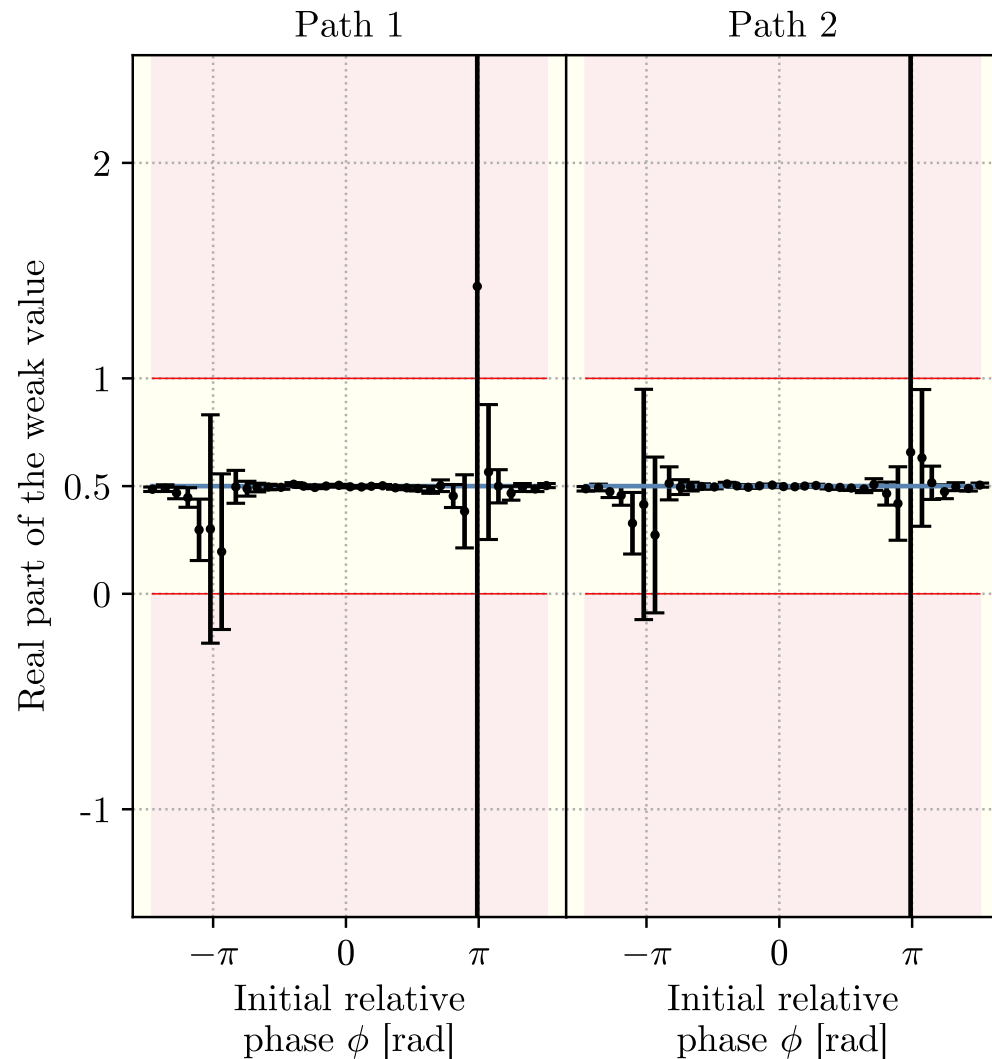
Weak value extraction:

$$w_{+,1}^{\text{R}} = \frac{I_{+,1}}{I_{+}(0)} + \frac{I_{+}(0) - I_{-}(0)}{4I_{+}(0)}$$

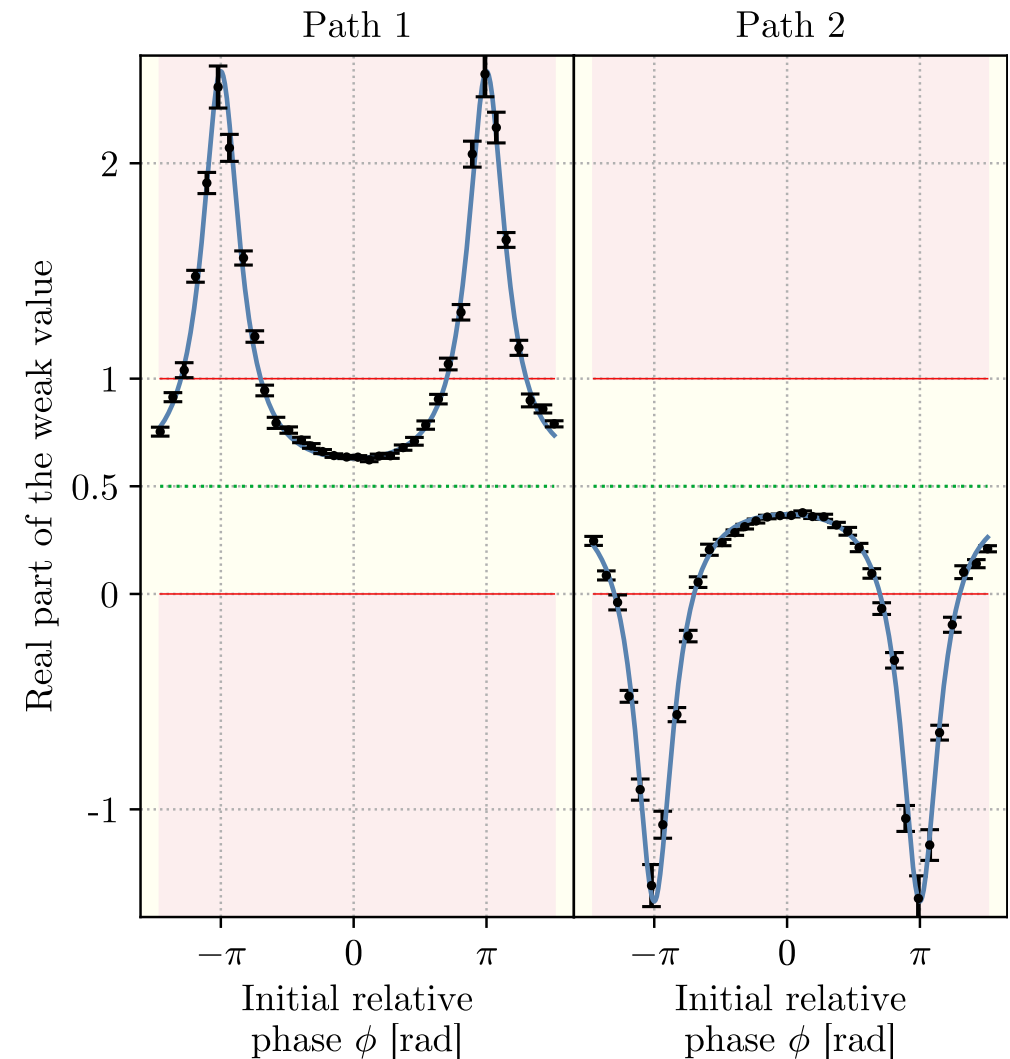
$$w_{+,1}^{\text{I}} = \frac{I_{+}(\frac{\pi}{2}) - I_{-}(\frac{\pi}{2})}{4I_{+}(0)}$$

Weak values from output intensities

Balanced: $|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle \approx \frac{|1\rangle + e^{i\phi}|2\rangle}{\sqrt{2}}$

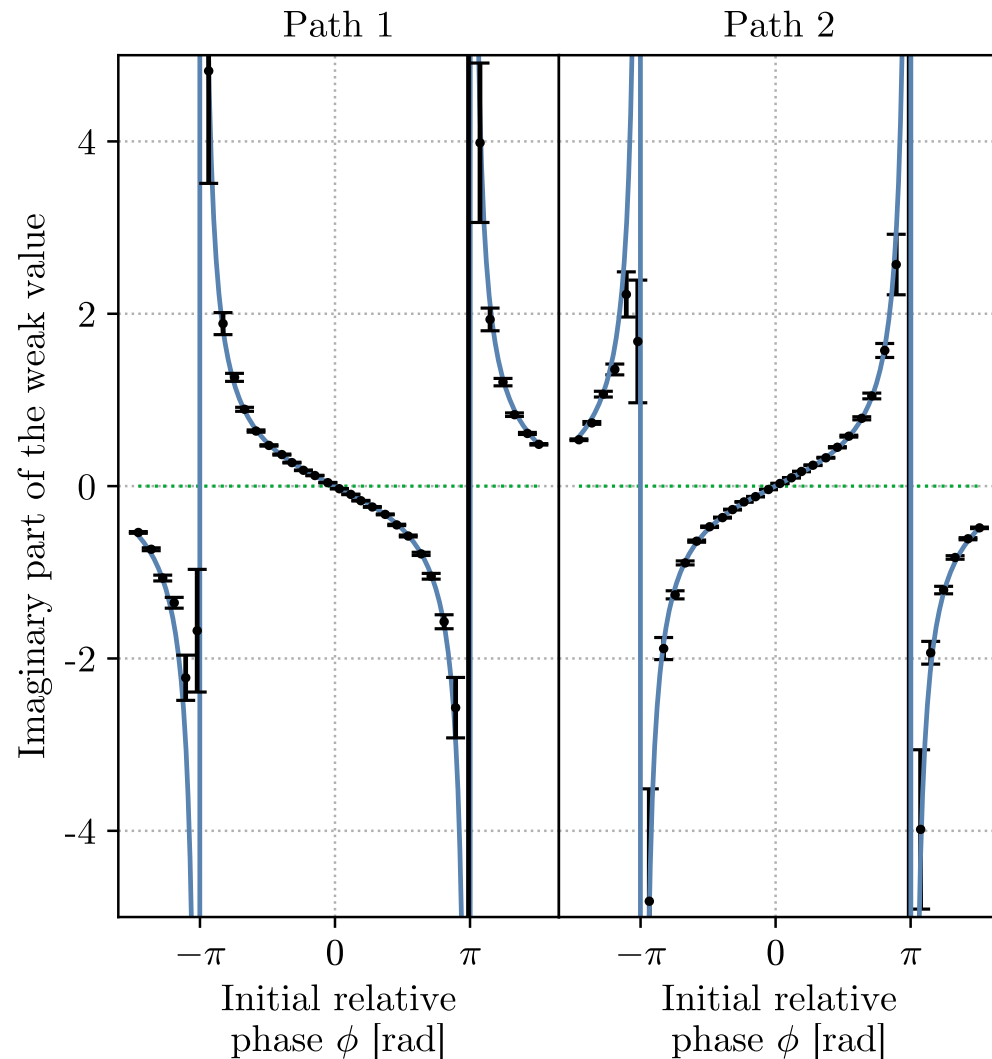


Unbalanced: $|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle \approx 0.86|1\rangle + 0.51 e^{i\phi}|2\rangle$

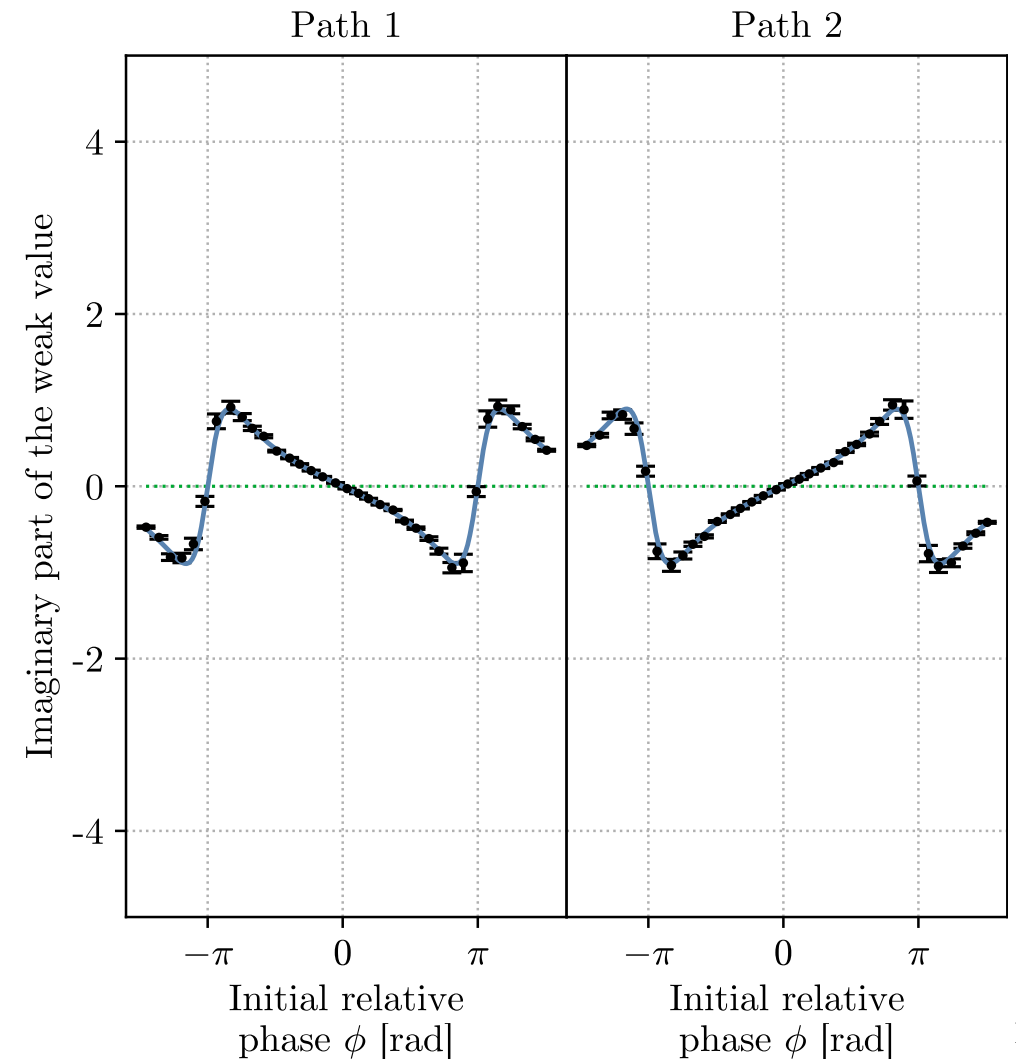


Weak values from output intensities

Balanced: $|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle \approx \frac{|1\rangle + e^{i\phi}|2\rangle}{\sqrt{2}}$

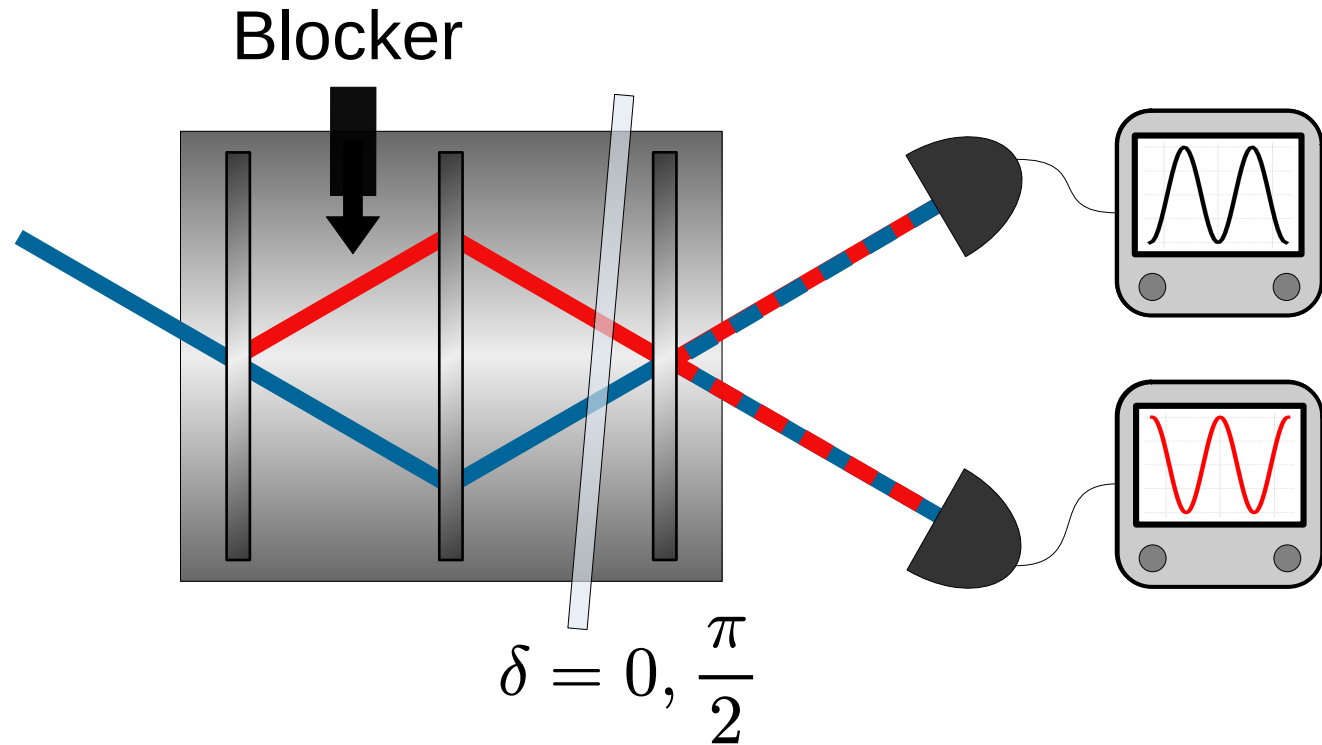


Unbalanced: $|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle \approx 0.86|1\rangle + 0.51 e^{i\phi}|2\rangle$



Required setup:

- Interferometer
- Path blocker
- Phase shifter

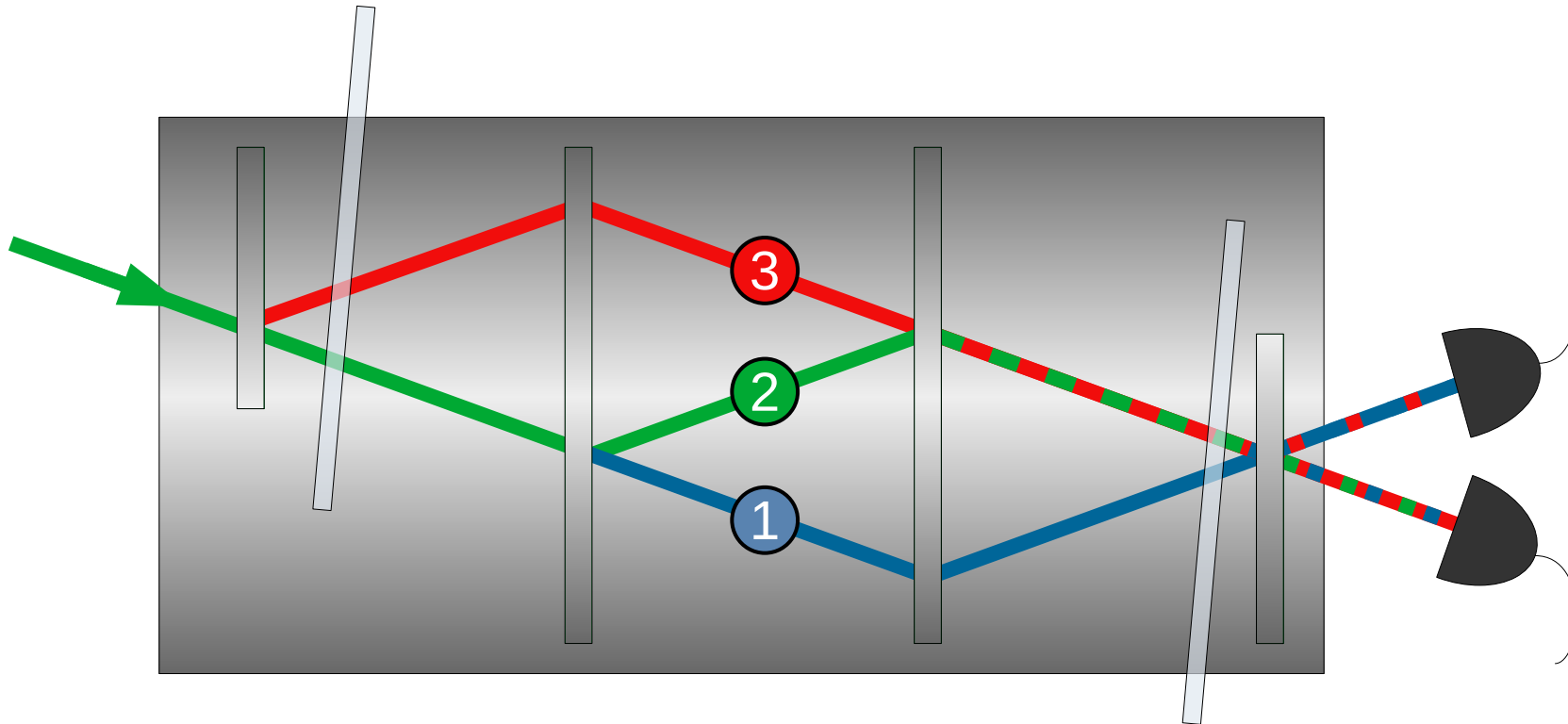


Measurements:

- No meter state and no weak interaction (shorter acquisition times with comparable or improved precision)
- 3 measurements needed to completely determine the path weak-values

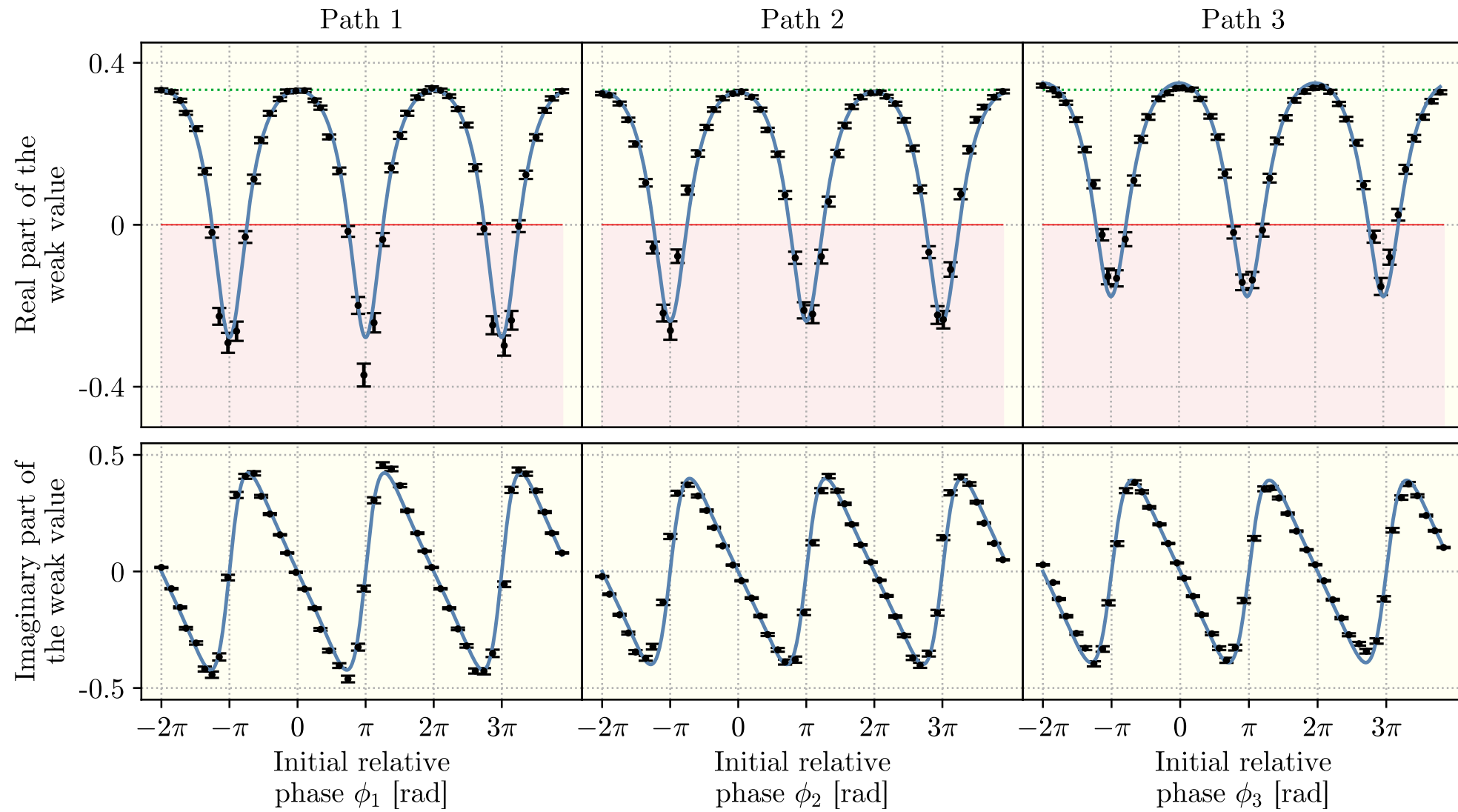
Bonus experimental result!

Three-path neutron interferometer:



Weak values from output intensities

Initial state: $|\psi_{\text{in}}\rangle \approx \frac{e^{i\phi_1}|1\rangle + e^{i\phi_2}|2\rangle + e^{i\phi_3}|3\rangle}{\sqrt{3}}$



- Quantum mechanics is nonclassical, but not always
- Weak values can be used to identify nonclassical phenomena
- Our group developed several methods to extract weak values in neutron interferometry
- In particular, one method that requires no weak interaction and no meter state was presented. The method can be applied any N-level quantum system in which alike measurements can be performed.

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Thank you for your attention!